CURIOUS SPAROOWS · ENCYCLOPEDIC INDEX

MOVIES

The complete map of world cinema, from shadow puppets to streaming

Film industries of every continent · every genre · movements · history · awards · people · craft · ideas · reviews

Parts	Sections	Sub-sections	Entries	Register rows
13	42	161	521	133

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How to Use This Booklet

This booklet is a map of the whole world of movies, from the first flickering films of 1895 to the streaming and AI era. It is not a book's contents page: every entry tells you, in one or two lines, what the thing is and why it matters. A newcomer can learn the shape of cinema just by turning the pages; a movie nerd can check that nothing is missing.

Every entry has an ID (such as MOV-01.4 for Malayalam cinema). The same ID is the entry's address on curioussparoows.com, where each one is growing into its own page.

How this booklet is organised

Parts: the big branches: the intro questions, industries of the world, genres, movements, history, awards, people, craft, ideas, reviews, community, navigation and sources.

Sections (MOV-01 to MOV-25): the main topics, each opening with a *Before you start* box.

Sub-sections and entries (☐): one or two lines each; tick the box when you have watched or explored it.

Film Registers: tables of landmark films, decade by decade, for each industry. They are a sourced selection; the full year-wise lists grow on the website.

How to explore it

Step 1. Read Part 0, twelve two-minute questions that tell the story of cinema.

Step 2. Find your own country and language in Part 1, then travel to another continent.

Step 3. Pick a genre you love in Part 2 and follow its example films.

Step 4. Use the tags (#india, #horror, #1950s) and See also links to jump between pages.

Step 5. Tick ☐ as you go, and use the tracker at the end.

Our promise

Knowledge belongs to the people who created it. Every fact here stands on a source listed in Part 12, and every "latest" fact says when it was checked. Where something could not be verified, we say so instead of guessing. Found a mistake? Tell us, and we will fix it and thank you.

Contents

Use View → Navigation Pane in Word (or the outline in Google Docs) to jump to any heading. Numbers in brackets show how many entries each section holds.

PART 0 — THE INTRODUCTION TWIG: WHY DO WE LOVE THE MOVIES?

MOV-00 The Gateway: Why do a few hours of moving light in a dark room change the way we see our lives? (5)
MOV-00.01 What did people do for stories before the movies?
MOV-00.02 Who made the first movie, and did audiences really run from a train?
MOV-00.03 Why does a row of still pictures look like it is moving?
MOV-00.04 How did India get its first film?
MOV-00.05 Why were silent films never silent?
MOV-00.06 What changed when movies learned to talk?
MOV-00.07 Why do we cry for people who do not exist?
MOV-00.08 How did movies become the world's biggest dream factory?
MOV-00.09 Why does every country make its films differently?
MOV-00.10 Did television, video and streaming try to kill the cinema?
MOV-00.11 How much money does a movie really make?
MOV-00.12 What is the future of the movies?
MOV-00.R Recap: The story of the movies in one page

PART 1 — FILM INDUSTRIES OF THE WORLD

MOV-01 Indian Cinema: one country, more than twenty film languages (151)
MOV-02 Cinema of the Americas (44)
MOV-03 Cinema of Europe (25)
MOV-04 Cinema of Asia (beyond India) (26)
MOV-05 Cinema of Africa and Oceania (10)

PART 2 — GENRES, FORMS AND FORMATS

MOV-06 Film genres and sub-genres (67)
MOV-07 Forms, formats and audiences (3)

PART 3 — MOVEMENTS, SCHOOLS AND STYLES

MOV-08 Film movements of the world (32)

PART 4 — THE HISTORY OF CINEMA: A TIMELINE

MOV-09 Timeline of world and Indian cinema (83)

PART 5 — AWARDS, FESTIVALS AND RECORDS

MOV-10 International film awards (14)
MOV-11 Film festivals of the world and their top prizes (30)
MOV-12 National film awards, country by country (30)
MOV-13 Records, firsts and fun facts (10)

PART 6 — THE PEOPLE OF CINEMA

MOV-14 Pioneers, masters and stars (16)

PART 7 — THE CRAFT, TECHNOLOGY AND BUSINESS OF FILM

MOV-15 Who does what: the film crew (13)
MOV-16 How a film is made, and the technology behind it (13)
MOV-17 The business, law and preservation of cinema (8)

PART 8 — IDEAS: THEORY, PHILOSOPHY, PSYCHOLOGY AND SOCIETY

MOV-18 Film theory and criticism (the big ideas) (13)
MOV-19 Cinema, mind and society (10)

PART 9 — REVIEWS AND VOICES

MOV-20 Critics' Corner: the great film critics (15)

MOV-21 The critics said, I say (page template)
MOV-22 My Review Desk (Kritikesh's review template) (10)

PART 10 — WATCHING, LEARNING AND COMMUNITY

MOV-23 The movie lover's practical guide (8)

PART 11 — NAVIGATION: TAGS, LINKS AND THE SITE MAP

MOV-24 Tag dictionary (9)
MOV-25 Cross-links and the website site map (3)

PART 12 — SOURCES, CREDITS AND EDITOR'S NOTES

MOV-S Sources and credits (6)
MOV-E Editor's notes (corrections and decisions on the brief)
MOV-T My Movie Tracker

PART 0 — THE INTRODUCTION TWIG: WHY DO WE LOVE THE MOVIES?

About this Part. This is the doorway to the whole Movies section of the website. It is written in the tree-twig format of the Curious Sparoows library: one Gateway page, twelve Leaves and one Recap. Each Leaf answers one question in about two minutes (250 to 400 words), shows its short answer at the top, and ends with an honest hook to the next question. On the website, a "Full journey" page shows all Leaves on one page for readers who like to scroll.

MOV-00 The Gateway: Why do a few hours of moving light in a dark room change the way we see our lives?

Web address: /movies/why-we-love-movies/ · **Keywords:** history of cinema for beginners, how movies began, why we love movies, cinema explained

The lights go down. A hundred strangers stop talking. For two hours, they laugh at the same joke, hold their breath at the same moment and walk out a little changed. Nothing in that room was real, and yet everyone felt something real.

This short course follows one question, **why do movies have such power over us?**, in twelve small steps: from storytellers around a fire to the Lumière brothers, from Dadasaheb Phalke to streaming and AI. Each page answers one question in about two minutes and hands you the next one. You can stop after any page and still leave with a complete answer.

By the end you will be able to:

- Tell the story of cinema in order, from shadow puppets to streaming.
- Explain why a row of still pictures looks like motion.
- Say how Indian cinema began and why it sings.
- Explain, with real ideas from India and the world, why we cry for people who do not exist.
- Read box-office numbers without being fooled by them.

MOV-00.01 What did people do for stories before the movies?

> **Short answer:** They gathered around storytellers, theatres, puppet shows and "magic lanterns". Cinema did not invent the human hunger for stories; it gave that hunger a new machine.

Keywords: entertainment before cinema, shadow puppets history, magic lantern, kathputli, history of storytelling

Stories around the fire

For most of human history, the movie screen was a face lit by fire. Storytellers carried epics in their memory. In India, kathakars, bhopas with their painted phad scrolls in Rajasthan, and singers of the Alha and Pabuji epics travelled from village to village. Their audiences knew the story already and came anyway, for the telling.

Theatre: the first "big screen"

Theatre gave stories a stage, costumes and an audience in rows. Bharata's **Natyashastra** (compiled roughly 200 BCE to 200 CE) is one of the oldest books on drama in the world, and Greek tragedy in Athens is of similar antiquity. Both understood something movies would later use: a crowd feels more together than alone.

Light and shadow

Long before electricity, people were already telling stories with light. Shadow puppets danced in India (tholu bommalata in Andhra Pradesh, togalu gombeyaata in Karnataka), in Indonesia (wayang kulit), in China and in Turkey (Karagöz). Rajasthan's kathputli used strings instead of shadows.

From the 1600s, the **magic lantern** projected painted glass slides onto a wall; it is usually credited to the Dutch scientist Christiaan Huygens around 1659. Showmen used moving slides, smoke and sound effects to make audiences scream at ghosts.

So what was missing?

Real motion. Every one of these arts could show a picture, or a performer moving live. None could capture a real moment and play it back. That was the dream of the 1800s.

> **Remember this:** Movies are the newest member of a very old family: the storyteller, the stage and the shadow on the wall.
>
> **Next:** So who first caught a real moment on film, and did audiences really run from a train?

MOV-00.02 Who made the first movie, and did audiences really run from a train?

> **Short answer:** The oldest surviving motion picture is Louis Le Prince's *Roundhay Garden Scene* (1888). Cinema as a public show began with the Lumière brothers' paid screening in Paris on 28 December 1895. The famous story of people running from a train is most likely a legend.

Keywords: first movie ever made, Lumière brothers, Roundhay Garden Scene, Edison kinetoscope, train panic myth

Many inventors, one race

In the 1880s and 1890s, inventors in France, Britain, the USA and Germany all raced to capture motion. **Eadweard Muybridge** photographed a galloping horse with a row of cameras in 1878. **Louis Le Prince** filmed a few seconds of people walking in a garden in Leeds in 1888. **Thomas Edison's** team, led by William Kennedy Laurie Dickson, built the **Kinetoscope**, a peep-show box for one viewer at a time (public from 1894).

The night cinema was born

Auguste and Louis Lumière built the **Cinématographe**, a camera that was also a projector. On **28 December 1895**, in the Salon Indien of the Grand Café in Paris, they showed about ten short films to a paying audience. One showed workers leaving their factory. Life itself had become a show.

The train that did not attack

The Arrival of a Train at La Ciotat is famous for making audiences flee. Film historians have found no reliable report of such a panic, and the film was not part of the first programme. The legend survived because it says something true: people had never seen anything like it.

From records to dreams

A magician named **Georges Méliès** saw the show and understood it could do more than record. His *A Trip to the Moon* (1902) used tricks, sets and stop-motion to make the impossible visible. Cinema now had two paths: the Lumières' real world and Méliès' dream world. Every film since walks one of them, or both.

> **Remember this:** Cinema has no single inventor. It was born from many hands, and became an art the moment someone used it to tell a story.
>
> **Next:** But a film strip is just a row of still photos. Why does it look like movement?

MOV-00.03 Why does a row of still pictures look like it is moving?

> **Short answer:** Your brain fills the gaps. When still images that differ slightly flash by fast enough, the visual system reads them as smooth motion. The old explanation, "persistence of vision", is now considered incomplete.

Keywords: how do movies work, frames per second, persistence of vision myth, phi phenomenon, 24 fps

A trick played by your brain

A film is a series of still frames. Show them fast and your brain stops seeing separate pictures and starts seeing a moving world. Psychologists call related effects **apparent motion** (the phi phenomenon and beta movement, studied by Max Wertheimer in 1912). The brain has motion detectors that respond to change between images, and they happily accept a well-timed series of stills.

Why "persistence of vision" is not the full story

Many textbooks still say an image "stays on the retina" and blends with the next. Lingering images do help hide the dark gap between frames, but they would produce a blur, not motion. The motion itself is built by the brain.

How fast is fast enough?

Silent films ran at around 16 to 20 frames per second, often varied by hand. With sound, speed had to be fixed so voices would not change pitch, and **24 frames per second** became the standard in the late 1920s. Projectors flash each frame two or three times, so the light flickers 48 or 72 times a second, too fast for most eyes to notice. Peter Jackson's *The Hobbit* (2012) tried 48 frames per second; many viewers felt it looked "too real", which shows how much our taste is trained by habit.

The pictures before the movies

Toys like the **zoetrope** and the **phenakistiscope** (1830s) proved the effect decades before film. Spin a drum of drawings, look through the slits, and a horse runs.

> **Remember this:** Motion in the movies lives in your head. The screen gives the brain clues; the brain makes the magic.

Next: Within months of Paris, those flickering pictures reached Bombay. How did India get its first film?

MOV-00.04 How did India get its first film?

> **Short answer:** The Lumière films were shown in Bombay on 7 July 1896. Dadasaheb Phalke's *Raja Harishchandra*, released on 3 May 1913, is generally regarded as India's first full-length feature film.

Keywords: first Indian film, Raja Harishchandra, Dadasaheb Phalke, Alam Ara first talkie, history of Indian cinema

Cinema arrives by ship

Barely six months after Paris, the Lumière agents showed their films at **Watson's Hotel in Bombay on 7 July 1896**. Indians soon picked up cameras: Harishchandra Sakharam Bhatavdekar ("Save Dada") filmed a wrestling match in Bombay in 1899, one of the first films shot by an Indian.

A printer who saw Christ on screen

Dhundiraj Govind Phalke was a printer and photographer. In 1910 he watched *The Life of Christ* and asked: why not Indian gods and heroes on screen? He went to London to learn, bought equipment, and filmed the story of the truthful king Harishchandra. No woman from a "respectable" family would act then, so a young man, **Anna Salunke**, played the queen Taramati. *Raja Harishchandra* opened at the Coronation Cinema, Bombay, on **3 May 1913**. (Some historians point to *Shree Pundalik*, 1912, as an earlier contender; it is usually treated as a filmed play.)

Mythology first, then everything

Early Indian films drew on the Ramayana, the Mahabharata and the Puranas, because audiences already loved those stories from theatre and katha. The South followed with *Keechaka Vadham* (1918), Bengal with Madan Theatres' productions, and soon studios rose in Bombay, Calcutta, Kolhapur, Pune and Madras.

The day India spoke

On **14 March 1931**, Ardeshir Irani's *Alam Ara* became India's first talkie. Within a year, films spoke Tamil, Telugu, Bengali and Marathi. Sound turned one Indian cinema into many: the birth of the language industries you will meet in Part 1.

> **Remember this:** Indian cinema began with a printer's dream and a myth everyone knew. India now certifies more feature films each year than any other country.
>
> **Next:** Before 1927, films everywhere had no recorded sound. So why do historians say silent films were never silent?

MOV-00.05 Why were silent films never silent?

> **Short answer:** Because almost every screening had live sound: a pianist, an organ, a full orchestra or, in Japan, a narrator called a benshi. The films had no recorded dialogue, but the cinema hall was full of music.

Keywords: silent film music, what is a benshi, Charlie Chaplin silent films, intertitles, silent era

The music in the room

In big city cinemas of the 1910s and 1920s, orchestras played scores written or arranged for the film. Smaller halls had a single pianist who improvised to the mood: chase music, love music, danger music. Cinema organs were built with drums, bells and bird whistles. In India too, silent shows were accompanied by live musicians, and sometimes by a narrator explaining the story.

The storytellers of Japan

Japan's **benshi** stood beside the screen and voiced characters, explained scenes and added commentary. Popular benshi were stars, and audiences chose cinemas by who was narrating. Their popularity is one reason Japan kept making silent films well into the 1930s.

Telling a story with the face

Without speech, actors and directors invented a universal language: faces, bodies and editing. **Charlie Chaplin**, **Buster Keaton** and **Harold Lloyd** made comedy that needs no translation even today. Short written cards called **intertitles** gave dialogue or explanations, and could be swapped for any language, which made silent films easy to sell around the world.

An art that peaked and vanished

By the late 1920s, films such as F. W. Murnau's *Sunrise* (1927) and Carl Theodor Dreyer's *The Passion of Joan of Arc* (1928) showed how far the silent art had grown. Then, within about three years, it was nearly gone. Sadly, most silent films are lost: the Library of Congress estimates that around 75 percent of American silent features no longer survive, and only a few fragments of India's roughly 1,300 silent films remain.

> **Remember this:** Silent cinema was a complete art of music, gesture and image, and it taught the world a shared language of the screen.
>
> **Next:** Then the movies learned to talk. What did they gain, and what did they lose?

MOV-00.06 What changed when movies learned to talk?

> **Short answer:** Sound arrived with *The Jazz Singer* (1927) and changed everything within a few years: acting, cameras, music, careers and, above all, language. In India, sound gave birth to film songs and to separate regional industries.

Keywords: first sound film, The Jazz Singer, talkies history, Alam Ara songs, why Indian films have songs

"You ain't heard nothin' yet"

Warner Bros. released *The Jazz Singer* in October 1927 using the **Vitaphone** system, which played sound from a disc in time with the film. Only parts of it had synchronised speech and song, but audiences were thrilled. By 1930, Hollywood had mostly stopped making silent films.

What was lost for a while

Early microphones were weak, so cameras were locked inside soundproof booths and actors had to stand near hidden microphones. Films became stiff for a few years. Some stars with voices or accents audiences disliked lost their careers. (The musical *Singin' in the Rain*, 1952, jokes about exactly this.) Soon cameras learned to move again, and sound became a new tool: the creak of a door, a silence before a gunshot.

Why India sings

Alam Ara (1931) had seven songs. Indian audiences came from a theatre tradition, from Parsi theatre to Sangeet Natak to folk forms, in which music and drama were one. So songs became the heart of Indian cinema, and playback singing (singers recording songs that actors lip-sync) became standard from the mid-1930s. Even today, a film's songs often reach people before the film does.

One cinema becomes many

Silent films could swap their intertitles for any language. Talkies could not. So sound split cinema along language lines everywhere. In India, Tamil, Telugu, Bengali, Marathi and later Kannada, Malayalam and other industries grew their own studios, stars and styles.

Remember this: Sound gave films a voice, and gave every language its own cinema.

Next: Talking pictures made us laugh and weep. But why do we cry for people who never existed?

MOV-00.07 Why do we cry for people who do not exist?

Short answer: Because the brain responds to stories much as it responds to real people, and because a film gives us emotion in a safe frame. Indian aesthetics calls this tasting of emotion "rasa"; Aristotle called its cleansing effect "catharsis".

Keywords: why do we cry at movies, rasa theory explained, catharsis, psychology of film, paradox of fiction

The puzzle

You know the hero is an actor. You know the music was added later. You cry anyway. Philosophers call this the **paradox of fiction** (the philosopher Colin Radford asked it sharply in 1975): how can we feel real emotions for what we know is unreal?

What the brain does

When we watch a character, we read faces, follow goals and predict danger, using the same social skills we use with real people. Brain-imaging studies show that watching emotions activates regions also involved in feeling them. Research by Paul Zak's team has linked emotionally gripping stories to a rise in oxytocin, a hormone tied to empathy, though such results are still debated. The short version: the brain does not fully switch off its caring system just because the person is fictional.

Rasa: India's answer, 2,000 years old

The **Natyashastra** says a performance creates **rasa**, a "taste" of emotion that the audience savours. We do not suffer the hero's grief; we taste *karuna* (compassion) in a refined, shared form. Classical writers listed eight rasas, and later thinkers such as **Abhinavagupta** added *shanta* (peace), making the famous **navarasa**. A good Indian "masala" film often tries to serve many rasas in one sitting, like a thali.

Catharsis and safety

Aristotle wrote that tragedy arouses pity and fear and brings their **catharsis**, a release or cleansing. Psychologists today add that films give us a safe rehearsal: we feel loss, fear or love without the real cost, and practise feeling for others.

The editing trick

In the 1920s, Soviet filmmaker Lev Kuleshov reportedly showed the same neutral face after shots of soup, a coffin and a child, and viewers "saw" hunger, grief and joy. This **Kuleshov effect** shows that much of the emotion is built by us.

Remember this: Movies borrow the brain's machinery for caring about people, and give it a safe space to feel.

Next: Emotion on that scale became a business. How did movies become the world's biggest dream factory?

MOV-00.08 How did movies become the world's biggest dream factory?

Short answer: Through studios and stars. From the 1910s, studios in Hollywood, Bombay, Madras, Tokyo and elsewhere made films like a factory makes cars, on a schedule, with salaried stars. That system made cinema the dominant popular art of the 20th century.

Keywords: Hollywood studio system, star system, Bombay Talkies, Prabhat studio, why is it called Hollywood

Why Hollywood?

American filmmakers moved west to Los Angeles in the 1910s for sunshine, varied landscapes and distance from Edison's patent company in the East. By the 1920s, Hollywood was the capital of world cinema.

The studio system

From about 1920 to 1950, five big studios (MGM, Paramount, Warner Bros., 20th Century-Fox and RKO) owned everything: writers, stars on long contracts, sound stages and even the cinemas. In 1948, the US Supreme Court's **Paramount decision** forced them to sell their cinemas, and the old system began to break.

India's studios

India built its own dream factories: **Prabhat** (Kolhapur, later Pune), **New Theatres** (Calcutta), **Bombay Talkies**, **Gemini** and **AVM** (Madras), **Vauhini** and **Vijaya** in the Telugu world. Actors, musicians and writers were on monthly salaries. After independence, independent producers and the star system took over.

The star system

Studios learned that people come to see *someone*. Stars became brands, from Charlie Chaplin and Greta Garbo to Raj Kapoor, Dilip Kumar, M. G. Ramachandran, N. T. Rama Rao, Rajkumar, Uttam Kumar, Amitabh Bachchan and Rajinikanth. In South India, film stars even became chief ministers: M. G. Ramachandran and J. Jayalalithaa in Tamil Nadu, N. T. Rama Rao in Andhra Pradesh.

How big is it now?

India certifies more feature films in a year than any other country, usually well over 1,500 (CBFC annual reports), and Nigeria's Nollywood is second or third by volume (UNESCO data). The USA still earns the most money worldwide.

Remember this: Studios turned dreams into a product and stars into family members of millions.

Next: Yet Hollywood, Bollywood, Seoul and Tehran make films that feel totally different. Why?

MOV-00.09 Why does every country make its films differently?

Short answer: Because films grow out of a country's language, history, money, censorship and taste in storytelling. Indian films serve many emotions with songs; Hollywood loves tight plots; Iranian and Italian masters found poetry in everyday life.

Keywords: world cinema explained, difference between Bollywood and Hollywood, Italian neorealism, Iranian cinema, Nollywood

Taste in stories

A typical Indian popular film runs longer, mixes action, comedy, romance and tears, and pauses for songs, because it grew from theatre and the **navarasa** idea (MOV-00.07). Hollywood screenwriting manuals teach a tight three-act structure around one goal. Neither is "right"; they are different meals.

History leaves fingerprints

After the Second World War, Italian directors with no money and ruined studios filmed on real streets with non-actors: **Italian neorealism** (*Bicycle Thieves*, 1948). It inspired Satyajit Ray to make *Pather Panchali* (1955). In the 1950s and 1960s, French critics who became directors broke the rules of editing: the **French New Wave**.

Limits that sparked creativity

Iranian filmmakers worked under strict censorship and often turned to children, landscapes and small moral stories; Abbas Kiarostami's *Taste of Cherry* won the Palme d'Or in 1997. Danish directors wrote themselves strict rules in the **Dogme 95** manifesto to escape big-budget habits.

Money shapes form

Nigeria's **Nollywood** grew from home-video tapes after *Living in Bondage* (1992): fast, cheap and close to its audience. South Korea built the "Korean wave" with screen quotas, investment and fearless genre films, leading to *Parasite* winning the Best Picture Oscar in 2020, the first non-English-language film to do so.

Language and market

A Malayalam film speaks to about 35 million native speakers; a Hindi or English film to hundreds of millions. That affects budgets, themes and risk-taking, and helps explain why smaller industries often surprise us with bold, realistic stories.

> **Remember this:** Every cinema is a mirror of its people, shaped by what they love, what they have lived through and what they are allowed to say.

Next: Cinema survived wars and censors. Then came television, video and streaming. Did they try to kill it?

MOV-00.10 Did television, video and streaming try to kill the cinema?

> **Short answer:** Each new screen was expected to kill cinema, and each time cinema changed instead: widescreen and colour against television, multiplexes against video, event films against streaming. Theatres shrank, but the habit of watching together survived.

Keywords: did TV kill cinema, CinemaScope history, VHS and movies, multiplex in India, streaming vs theatres

Round one: television (1950s)

As American families bought televisions, cinema attendance fell sharply. Hollywood fought back with what a small black-and-white box could not give: **colour**, **widescreen** (CinemaScope, launched with *The Robe*, 1953), 3D glasses and huge epics such as *Ben-Hur* (1959). In India, television spread later, in the 1980s, with Doordarshan's *Ramayan* (1987) emptying streets on Sunday mornings.

Round two: video (1970s to 1990s)

Videocassettes let people watch films at home and also made piracy easy. In 1984, the US Supreme Court ruled in the "Betamax case" that home recording for personal use was legal. Studios then found that selling tapes was very profitable. In India, the video boom of the 1980s hurt cinemas and audiences moved back with better halls; the first multiplex, PVR Anupam in Delhi (1997), began a new era.

Round three: streaming (2007 onwards)

Netflix began streaming in 2007; then came Amazon Prime Video, Disney+, Hotstar and many more. During the COVID-19 pandemic (2020 to 2021), cinemas closed and many films went straight to streaming. Some people predicted the end of theatres. Instead, big "event" films returned audiences to halls, and films such as *RRR* and *Oppenheimer* became shared experiences again.

What survives

Each round killed something (the newsreel, the single-screen village theatre, the DVD shop) and kept the core: a story, a dark room and people feeling it together.

Remember this: New screens do not kill old ones; they force them to discover what only they can do.

Next: Theatres, TV, streaming: someone is paying for all of this. How much money does a film really make?

MOV-00.11 How much money does a movie really make?

Short answer: Less than the headline number. "Box office" usually means gross ticket sales, of which cinemas keep a large share and taxes take another. Studios also earn from streaming, TV, music and other rights. As checked on 5 October 2026, the highest worldwide gross is *Avengers: Endgame* (about US$2.93 billion after a 2026 re-release), just ahead of *Avatar*.

Keywords: highest grossing movie of all time, box office explained, gross vs net collection, Indian box office, film budget

Gross, net and share

Gross is the total value of tickets sold. In India, trade reports also quote **net** (gross minus GST and local taxes). From the net, the cinema keeps its share, and the rest (the **distributor share**) goes back toward the producer. A film with a "₹300 crore" headline might return far less to the people who made it.

Budget is only half the cost

A film's production budget does not include marketing, which for a big Hollywood release can equal a large part of the budget. A common rule of thumb is that a theatrical film must earn roughly two to three times its budget at the box office to break even, though every deal is different.

The other money

Indian producers often sell **satellite, digital (streaming) and music rights** before release, sometimes covering a large share of the cost. Hollywood earns from streaming licences, TV, merchandise and theme parks.

The record holders (as checked on 5 October 2026)

Worldwide, not adjusted for inflation: *Avengers: Endgame* (2019) about US$2.925 billion, *Avatar* (2009) about US$2.923 billion, *Avatar: The Way of Water* (2022), *Titanic* (1997) and China's *Ne Zha 2* (2025), the highest-grossing animated film and non-English-language film (figures: Euronews from Box Office Mojo data). Adjusted for inflation, *Gone with the Wind* (1939) is usually ranked first (Guinness World Records). In India, *Dangal* (2016) is the highest-grossing Indian film worldwide, at around ₹2,000 crore, much of it earned in China.

Why numbers mislead

Figures are rarely audited publicly, are reported by interested parties and change with exchange rates and re-releases. That is why this site always gives the source and date.

Remember this: Box office is a scoreboard, not a bank statement. Read it with the source and date.

Next: With streaming, AI and virtual sets, the movies are changing again. What is their future?

MOV-00.12 What is the future of the movies?

> **Short answer:** Movies are moving toward virtual production, AI-assisted tools, global audiences and streaming-first releases, while the big-screen event survives. The open questions are about creativity, jobs and trust, not about whether people will still want stories.

Keywords: future of cinema, AI in filmmaking, virtual production LED volume, pan-Indian films, will cinemas survive

New tools on set

Virtual production uses giant LED screens showing computer-generated backgrounds that move with the camera, popularised by the series *The Mandalorian* (2019). Directors can shoot a desert or a planet inside a studio, with real light falling on the actors.

AI: helper or threat?

AI can now help with editing, dubbing, de-ageing, visual effects and even generating short clips. In 2023, Hollywood's writers (WGA) and actors (SAG-AFTRA) went on long strikes, in part to win protections against unconsented use of AI and digital replicas. The debate continues worldwide, and India's industry is having it too.

One world, many languages

Subtitles and dubbing on streaming platforms have made language less of a wall. *Parasite*, *RRR*, *Squid Game* (a series) and *KPop Demon Hunters* (Best Animated Feature at the 2026 Oscars) found global audiences. In India, "pan-Indian" films like *Baahubali*, *K.G.F* and *Pushpa* are released in five or more languages at once. *RRR*'s "Naatu Naatu" won the Oscar for Best Original Song in 2023.

New forms

Interactive films (*Black Mirror: Bandersnatch*, 2018), virtual reality, vertical "micro-dramas" on phones and games that feel like films are all testing the edges of what a movie is.

The question that remains

Every new technology has changed *how* we watch. None has changed *why*. We still want to sit with others in the dark and feel a story together. That is the thread you will follow through the rest of this site.

> **Remember this:** The future of film will be decided less by machines than by whether stories keep earning our trust.

MOV-00.R Recap: The story of the movies in one page

Keywords: history of cinema summary, cinema quiz, movies for beginners

1. Cinema joined the oldest human habit: telling stories with voice, stage and shadow.
2. Many inventors created moving pictures; the Lumières' 1895 screening began cinema as a public show.
3. Motion on screen is built by your brain from fast still images (24 per second as the standard).
4. India's first full-length feature was *Raja Harishchandra* (1913); its first talkie, *Alam Ara* (1931).
5. Silent films were full of live music; sound (1927) gave films a voice and split cinema into language industries.
6. We cry at films because the brain cares about people even in stories; India calls this tasting of emotion rasa.
7. Studios and stars made cinema a world industry; India makes the most films, the USA earns the most.
8. Each new screen (TV, video, streaming) changed cinema without ending it.

Test yourself: Who held the first paid screening? Why 24 frames? What is rasa? What is the difference between gross and net? Which was India's first talkie?

Where next on the site: World film industries (Part 1) · Genres (Part 2) · Movements (Part 3) · Timeline (Part 4) · Awards (Part 5) · Critics and my reviews (Part 9).

PART 1 — FILM INDUSTRIES OF THE WORLD

About this Part. The first great classification: where films are made. It goes from India to every continent. Each industry has a one- or two-line identity card (language, centre, nickname, first film, signature), its key eras, its legends and a **Film Register** of landmark films, decade by decade. Nicknames ending in "-wood" are informal; the proper name is given first. **The registers are a curated landmark selection, not a complete list**: see "How the registers grow" at the end of this Part.

Register fields. Year · Film · Director · Lead cast · Box office / reception · Major awards and why it matters. A dash (—) means not recorded here, never a guess. Box-office figures are approximate, not inflation-adjusted, and carry their source in Part 13.

MOV-01 Indian Cinema: one country, more than twenty film languages

Before you start — MOV-01. India is the world's largest film producer by number of films. It is not one industry but a family of language industries that share stars, music and technicians, and increasingly release "pan-Indian" films in many languages at once. Start with Hindi cinema, then the four big southern industries, then the East, West, North-east and the smaller language cinemas. **See also:** MOV-09 History, MOV-12.1 Indian awards, MUS (film music), BOK (adaptations).

☐ MOV-01.1 Hindi cinema (Bollywood)

Films in Hindi and Hindustani, centred in Mumbai (Bombay, hence "Bollywood"). Born with *Raja Harishchandra* (1913) and the talkie *Alam Ara* (1931); known worldwide for song-and-dance, melodrama, stars and the masala mix of every emotion. **Tags:** #india #hindi #mumbai #bollywood

- ☐ **Silent era (1913–1931)**: mythologicals and stunts from Phalke's Hindustan Film Company, Kohinoor and Imperial studios.
- ☐ **Studio era (1930s–1940s)**: Bombay Talkies (Himanshu Rai, Devika Rani), Prabhat, Ranjit, Minerva Movietone (Sohrab Modi), Wadia Movietone (Fearless Nadia).
- ☐ **Golden age (1947–1960s)**: social realism and romance of Raj Kapoor, Guru Dutt, Bimal Roy, Mehboob Khan, V. Shantaram; the music of Naushad, S. D. Burman, Shankar–Jaikishan; Lata Mangeshkar and Mohammed Rafi.
- ☐ **Colour, romance and Rajesh Khanna (1960s–early 1970s)**: Kashmir songs, Shammi Kapoor's energy, the first superstar Rajesh Khanna.
- ☐ **Angry young man and masala (1973–1980s)**: Amitabh Bachchan, the writers Salim–Javed, multi-starrers like *Sholay*.
- ☐ **Parallel / New Indian Cinema (1969–1990s)**: state-funded (FFC, later NFDC) realist cinema: Mrinal Sen (Hindi work), Shyam Benegal, Govind Nihalani, Mani Kaul, Kumar Shahani, Saeed Mirza, Sai Paranjpye.
- ☐ **Romance and the NRI era (1989–2000s)**: *Maine Pyar Kiya*, *DDLJ*; Shah Rukh, Salman and Aamir Khan; overseas markets; corporatisation (industry status for film, 2001).
- ☐ **Multiplex and new-wave Hindi films (2000s–2010s)**: Dibakar Banerjee, Anurag Kashyap, Vishal Bhardwaj, Zoya Akhtar, Rajkumar Hirani; small-town stories.
- ☐ **Streaming and pan-India (2020s)**: OTT originals, South-Indian dubbed hits in the Hindi belt, big-event films.
- ☐ **Signature elements**: playback songs, item numbers, dialogue-baazi, family melodrama, interval twist, censorship by CBFC certificate (U, U/A 7+, 13+, 16+, A, S).

Film Register — Hindi cinema (landmark selection)

Year	Film	Director	Lead cast	Box office / reception	Awards and why it matters
1913	Raja Harishchandra (silent; Marathi intertitles also)	Dadasaheb Phalke	D. D. Dabke, Anna Salunke	—	Generally regarded as India's first full-length feature film
1931	Alam Ara	Ardeshir Irani	Master Vithal, Zubeida, Prithviraj Kapoor	Huge success	India's first talkie; seven songs
1936	Achhut Kanya	Franz Osten	Ashok Kumar, Devika Rani	Hit	Bombay Talkies; inter-caste love story
1943	Kismet	Gyan Mukherjee	Ashok Kumar, Mumtaz Shanti	Ran over three years at	Early "anti-hero"

				Roxy, Calcutta	blockbuster
1946	Neecha Nagar	Chetan Anand	Kamini Kaushal, Rafiq Anwar	—	Shared the Grand Prix at the first Cannes festival (1946)
1951	Awaara	Raj Kapoor	Raj Kapoor, Nargis, Prithviraj Kapoor	Hit in India, USSR, Turkey, China	Made Raj Kapoor a global star
1953	Do Bigha Zamin	Bimal Roy	Balraj Sahni, Nirupa Roy	—	First Filmfare Best Film; Prix International, Cannes 1954
1957	Mother India	Mehboob Khan	Nargis, Sunil Dutt, Rajendra Kumar, Raaj Kumar	Among the biggest hits of its era	India's first Oscar nomination (Best Foreign Language Film)
1957	Pyaasa	Guru Dutt	Guru Dutt, Waheeda Rehman, Mala Sinha	—	On TIME's All-Time 100 Movies list (2005)
1960	Mughal-e-Azam	K. Asif	Prithviraj Kapoor, Dilip Kumar, Madhubala	Record grosser for years	Epic of Salim and Anarkali; colourised re-release 2004
1965	Guide	Vijay Anand	Dev Anand, Waheeda Rehman	Hit	From R. K. Narayan's novel; India's Oscar submission
1969	Aradhana	Shakti Samanta	Rajesh Khanna, Sharmila Tagore	Blockbuster	Launched Rajesh Khanna's superstardom
1969	Bhuvan Shome	Mrinal Sen	Utpal Dutt, Suhasini Mulay	—	Start of the New Indian Cinema; National Award Best Feature Film
1973	Zanjeer	Prakash Mehra	Amitabh Bachchan, Jaya Bhaduri, Pran	Hit	Birth of the "angry young man"
1974	Ankur	Shyam Benegal	Shabana Azmi, Anant Nag	—	Landmark of parallel cinema
1975	Sholay	Ramesh Sippy	Dharmendra, Amitabh Bachchan, Sanjeev Kumar, Hema Malini, Jaya Bhaduri, Amjad Khan	Ran about five years at Minerva, Mumbai	Often called the greatest Hindi blockbuster
1975	Deewaar	Yash Chopra	Amitabh Bachchan, Shashi Kapoor, Nirupa Roy	Hit	"Mere paas maa hai": Salim–Javed's classic
1983	Jaane Bhi Do Yaaro	Kundan Shah	Naseeruddin Shah, Ravi Baswani	Cult classic	NFDC-produced satire
1988	Salaam Bombay!	Mira Nair	Shafiq Syed	—	Caméra d'Or, Cannes 1988; Oscar nomination
1994	Hum Aapke Hain Koun..!	Sooraj Barjatya	Madhuri Dixit, Salman Khan	Blockbuster	Family-wedding musical that brought families back to halls
1995	Dilwale Dulhania Le Jayenge	Aditya Chopra	Shah Rukh Khan, Kajol	Blockbuster	Longest-running film in Indian cinema history (Maratha Mandir, Mumbai)
1998	Satya	Ram Gopal Varma	J. D. Chakravarthy, Manoj Bajpayee, Urmila Matondkar	Hit	Reinvented the Mumbai gangster film
2001	Lagaan	Ashutosh Gowariker	Aamir Khan, Gracy Singh	Hit	Oscar nomination, Best Foreign Language Film
2001	Dil Chahta Hai	Farhan Akhtar	Aamir Khan, Saif Ali Khan, Akshaye Khanna	Hit	Voice of urban youth
2009	3 Idiots	Rajkumar Hirani	Aamir Khan, R. Madhavan, Sharman Joshi, Kareena Kapoor	Record grosser at release	Education satire loved across Asia
2012	Gangs of Wasseypur	Anurag Kashyap	Manoj Bajpayee, Nawazuddin Siddiqui, Richa Chadha	Cult hit	Premiered at Cannes Directors' Fortnight
2016	Dangal	Nitesh Tiwari	Aamir Khan, Fatima Sana Shaikh, Sanya Malhotra	About ₹2,000 crore worldwide	Highest-grossing Indian film worldwide
2023	Jawan	Atlee	Shah Rukh Khan, Nayanthara, Vijay Sethupathi	Blockbuster	Shah Rukh Khan's first National Award (Best Actor, 71st, shared)
2023	12th Fail	Vidhu Vinod Chopra	Vikrant Massey, Medha Shankr	Sleeper hit	Best Feature Film, 71st National Film Awards

2024	Laapataa Ladies	Kiran Rao	Nitanshi Goel, Pratibha Ranta, Sparsh Shrivastav	Hit	13 Filmfare Awards (2025) including Best Film; India's Oscar entry

☐ MOV-01.2 Tamil cinema (Kollywood)

Films in Tamil, centred in Chennai (Kodambakkam, hence "Kollywood"). First talkie *Kalidas* (1931); deeply tied to Dravidian politics, star cults and bold music. **Tags:** #india #tamil #chennai #kollywood

☐ **Silent beginnings**: *Keechaka Vadham* (1918, R. Nataraja Mudaliar), the first South Indian silent feature.

☐ **Studio era**: Gemini (S. S. Vasan), AVM (A. V. Meiyappan), Modern Theatres (Salem).

☐ **Dravidian film politics**: writers C. N. Annadurai and M. Karunanidhi; stars M. G. Ramachandran and J. Jayalalithaa became chief ministers.

☐ **The great acting traditions**: Sivaji Ganesan, Gemini Ganesan, Savitri; later Kamal Haasan and Rajinikanth.

☐ **Village realism (late 1970s)**: Bharathiraja, Mahendran, Balu Mahendra.

☐ **The Mani Ratnam and A. R. Rahman era (1980s–1990s)**.

☐ **New-wave Tamil (2000s–)**: Bala, Vetrimaaran, Pa. Ranjith, Karthik Subbaraj, Lokesh Kanagaraj's "Cinematic Universe".

Film Register — Tamil cinema (landmark selection)

Year	Film	Director	Lead cast	Box office / reception	Awards and why it matters
1931	Kalidas	H. M. Reddy	T. P. Rajalakshmi, P. G. Venkatesan	Success	First Tamil talkie (with Telugu songs)
1948	Chandralekha	S. S. Vasan	T. R. Rajakumari, M. K. Radha, Ranjan	Big hit, also in Hindi	Gemini's spectacle; drum-dance sequence
1952	Parasakthi	Krishnan–Panju	Sivaji Ganesan, Pandari Bai	Hit	Sivaji Ganesan's debut; Karunanidhi's fiery dialogues
1977	16 Vayathinile	Bharathiraja	Kamal Haasan, Sridevi, Rajinikanth	Hit	Took Tamil cinema out of the studio into the village
1987	Nayakan	Mani Ratnam	Kamal Haasan, Saranya	Hit	On TIME's All-Time 100 Movies; Kamal Haasan's National Award
1992	Roja	Mani Ratnam	Arvind Swamy, Madhoo	Hit in many languages	A. R. Rahman's debut score; National Award for music
1995	Baashha	Suresh Krissna	Rajinikanth, Nagma, Raghuvaran	Blockbuster	Defined Rajinikanth's mass hero image
2010	Enthiran	S. Shankar	Rajinikanth, Aishwarya Rai	Record grosser at release	Science-fiction spectacle with VFX
2021	Jai Bhim	T. J. Gnanavel	Suriya, Lijomol Jose	Streaming hit	Custodial-violence drama based on a real case
2022	Ponniyin Selvan: I	Mani Ratnam	Vikram, Aishwarya Rai, Karthi, Jayam Ravi, Trisha	Blockbuster	From Kalki Krishnamurthy's novel
2023	Jailer	Nelson Dilipkumar	Rajinikanth, Mohanlal (cameo), Shiva Rajkumar (cameo)	Blockbuster	Pan-South star cameo strategy

☐ MOV-01.3 Telugu cinema (Tollywood)

Films in Telugu, centred in Hyderabad (earlier Madras). Known for mythologicals, larger-than-life heroes and, today, India's biggest pan-Indian spectacles. **Tags:** #india #telugu #hyderabad #tollywood

☐ **Beginnings**: *Bhishma Pratigna* (1921, R. S. Prakash) silent; *Bhakta Prahlada* (1932, H. M. Reddy) usually counted as the first Telugu talkie.

☐ **Golden age (1950s–1960s)**: Vijaya and Vauhini studios; N. T. Rama Rao (as Krishna and Rama), Akkineni Nageswara Rao, Savitri, S. V. Ranga Rao.

☐ **K. Viswanath's music films and the art-house of B. Narsing Rao**.

☐ **Mass-hero era**: Chiranjeevi, Balakrishna, Nagarjuna, Venkatesh; then Mahesh Babu, Pawan Kalyan, Allu Arjun, Prabhas, Jr NTR, Ram Charan.

☐ **Ramoji Film City** (1996), among the largest film studio complexes in the world (Guinness World Records).

☐ **Rajamouli and the pan-Indian wave (2015–)**.

Film Register — Telugu cinema (landmark selection)

Year	Film	Director	Lead cast	Box office / reception	Awards and why it matters
1932	Bhakta Prahlada	H. M. Reddy	Munipalle Subbaiah, Surabhi Kamalabai	—	Usually counted as the first Telugu talkie
1957	Mayabazar	K. V. Reddy	N. T. Rama Rao, A. Nageswara Rao, Savitri, S. V. Ranga Rao	Hit	Voted the greatest Indian film in a 2013 CNN-IBN poll
1979	Sankarabharanam	K. Viswanath	J. V. Somayajulu, Manju Bhargavi	Hit, also outside Andhra	National Film Award; revived interest in Carnatic music
1989	Shiva	Ram Gopal Varma	Nagarjuna, Amala	Hit	Changed the style of Telugu action filmmaking
2009	Magadheera	S. S. Rajamouli	Ram Charan, Kajal Aggarwal	Record grosser at release	Reincarnation epic; VFX breakthrough
2015	Baahubali: The Beginning	S. S. Rajamouli	Prabhas, Rana Daggubati, Anushka Shetty, Tamannaah	Blockbuster	National Award Best Feature Film; started the pan-Indian era
2017	Baahubali 2: The Conclusion	S. S. Rajamouli	Prabhas, Rana Daggubati, Anushka Shetty	About ₹1,800 crore worldwide	Among the highest-grossing Indian films
2021	Pushpa: The Rise	Sukumar	Allu Arjun, Rashmika Mandanna, Fahadh Faasil	Blockbuster	Allu Arjun: first Telugu actor to win National Award Best Actor
2022	RRR	S. S. Rajamouli	N. T. Rama Rao Jr., Ram Charan, Alia Bhatt, Ajay Devgn	Blockbuster	"Naatu Naatu": Oscar for Best Original Song (2023), M. M. Keeravani and Chandrabose
2024	Kalki 2898 AD	Nag Ashwin	Prabhas, Amitabh Bachchan, Deepika Padukone, Kamal Haasan	Blockbuster	Mythological science fiction

☐ MOV-01.4 Malayalam cinema (Mollywood)

Films in Malayalam, from Kerala (Kochi and Thiruvananthapuram). Small market, huge reputation: realism, writing and actors such as Mohanlal and Mammootty. **Tags:** #india #malayalam #kerala #mollywood

☐ **Pioneers**: *Vigathakumaran* (1928, J. C. Daniel, "father of Malayalam cinema"; P. K. Rosy, the first heroine, a Dalit woman driven out by upper-caste protests).

☐ **First talkie**: *Balan* (1938, S. Nottani).

☐ **Literary golden age (1950s–1970s)**: adaptations of Thakazhi, Basheer, M. T. Vasudevan Nair.

☐ **Art cinema masters**: Adoor Gopalakrishnan, G. Aravindan, Shaji N. Karun, John Abraham.

☐ **Middle cinema (1980s–1990s)**: P. Padmarajan, Bharathan, K. G. George, Sathyan Anthikad, Priyadarshan; writer Sreenivasan.

☐ **New Generation (2010s–)**: Lijo Jose Pellissery, Dileesh Pothan, Aashiq Abu; actors Fahadh Faasil, Parvathy Thiruvothu.

Film Register — Malayalam cinema (landmark selection)

Year	Film	Director	Lead cast	Box office / reception	Awards and why it matters
1928	Vigathakumaran (silent)	J. C. Daniel	J. C. Daniel, P. K. Rosy	—	First Malayalam film
1938	Balan	S. Nottani	K. K. Aroor, M. K. Kamalam	—	First Malayalam talkie
1954	Neelakuyil	P. Bhaskaran, Ramu Kariat	Sathyan, Miss Kumari	—	National Award; social realism on caste
1965	Chemmeen	Ramu Kariat	Madhu, Sheela, Sathyan	Hit	First South Indian film to win the National Award for Best Feature Film
1972	Swayamvaram	Adoor	Madhu, Sharada	—	Start of the Malayalam new

		Gopalakrishnan			wave; National Awards
1981	Elippathayam	Adoor Gopalakrishnan	Karamana Janardanan Nair, Sharada	—	BFI Sutherland Trophy
1988	Piravi	Shaji N. Karun	Premji, Archana	—	Caméra d'Or special mention, Cannes 1989
1993	Manichitrathazhu	Fazil	Mohanlal, Shobana, Suresh Gopi	Blockbuster	Shobana: National Award Best Actress; remade as Bhool Bhulaiyaa
2013	Drishyam	Jeethu Joseph	Mohanlal, Meena	Record grosser at release	Remade in several Indian languages and abroad
2016	Maheshinte Prathikaaram	Dileesh Pothan	Fahadh Faasil, Aparna Balamurali	Hit	Icon of the realist new generation
2021	The Great Indian Kitchen	Jeo Baby	Nimisha Sajayan, Suraj Venjaramoodu	Streaming success	Started national debate on domestic labour
2024	Manjummel Boys	Chidambaram	Soubin Shahir, Sreenath Bhasi	Among the top Malayalam grossers	Survival drama from a true story
2024	All We Imagine as Light (Malayalam/Hindi)	Payal Kapadia	Kani Kusruti, Divya Prabha, Chhaya Kadam	—	Grand Prix, Cannes 2024: first Indian film in the main competition in 30 years

☐ MOV-01.5 Kannada cinema (Sandalwood)

Films in Kannada, centred in Bengaluru ("Sandalwood" after Karnataka's sandalwood). Home of the beloved Dr Rajkumar, of literary new-wave cinema and of the *K.G.F* and *Kantara* phenomena. **Tags:** #india #kannada #bengaluru #sandalwood

☐ **First talkie**: *Sati Sulochana* (1934, Y. V. Rao).

☐ **Dr Rajkumar era (1954–2000s)**: from *Bedara Kannappa* (1954) to over 200 films.

☐ **New wave (1970s)**: *Samskara*, Girish Karnad, B. V. Karanth, Girish Kasaravalli, Puttanna Kanagal.

☐ **Modern stars**: Vishnuvardhan, Ambareesh, Shiva Rajkumar, Puneeth Rajkumar, Sudeep, Yash, Rishab Shetty.

☐ **Pan-Indian breakthrough (2018–)**: *K.G.F*, *Kantara*.

Film Register — Kannada cinema (landmark selection)

Year	Film	Director	Lead cast	Box office / reception	Awards and why it matters
1934	Sati Sulochana	Y. V. Rao	Subbaiah Naidu, Tripuramba	—	First Kannada talkie
1954	Bedara Kannappa	H. L. N. Simha	Rajkumar, Pandari Bai	Hit	Debut of Dr Rajkumar
1970	Samskara	Pattabhirama Reddy	Girish Karnad, Snehalata Reddy	—	From U. R. Ananthamurthy's novel; National Award Best Feature Film
1972	Bangaarada Manushya	Siddalingaiah	Rajkumar, Bharathi	Record theatrical run	Inspired rural youth to farm
1977	Ghatashraddha	Girish Kasaravalli	Ajith Kumar, Meena Kuttappa	—	National Award Best Feature Film
2018	K.G.F: Chapter 1	Prashanth Neel	Yash, Srinidhi Shetty	Blockbuster	Took Kannada films pan-Indian
2022	K.G.F: Chapter 2	Prashanth Neel	Yash, Sanjay Dutt, Raveena Tandon	Blockbuster	Among the highest-grossing Indian films
2022	Kantara	Rishab Shetty	Rishab Shetty, Sapthami Gowda	Sleeper blockbuster	Rishab Shetty: National Award Best Actor (70th); Bhoota Kola tradition
2025	Kantara: Chapter 1	Rishab Shetty	Rishab Shetty, Rukmini Vasanth	Blockbuster	Prequel; one of 2025's biggest Indian films

☐ MOV-01.6 Bengali cinema (Tollywood of Tollygunge)

Films in Bengali, centred in Tollygunge, Kolkata (the original "Tollywood", a name that probably inspired "Bollywood"). Home of Satyajit Ray, Ritwik Ghatak and Mrinal Sen; also a thriving industry in Bangladesh (MOV-04.5). **Tags:** #india #bengali #kolkata #tollywood

☐ **Madan Theatres and New Theatres (1917–1950s)**: *Bilwamangal* (1919), *Devdas* (1935, P. C. Barua).

☐ **The great trio**: Satyajit Ray (*Apu Trilogy*), Ritwik Ghatak (*Partition trilogy*), Mrinal Sen (*Calcutta trilogy*).

☐ **Uttam Kumar and Suchitra Sen**: the romantic pair of the 1950s–1960s.

☐ **Later auteurs**: Tapan Sinha, Tarun Majumdar, Aparna Sen, Buddhadeb Dasgupta, Goutam Ghose, Rituparno Ghosh.

☐ **Contemporary**: Kaushik Ganguly, Srijit Mukherji, Anik Dutta; detective franchises (Feluda, Byomkesh).

Film Register — Bengali cinema (landmark selection)

Year	Film	Director	Lead cast	Box office / reception	Awards and why it matters
1935	Devdas	P. C. Barua	P. C. Barua, Jamuna	Hit	Defined the tragic hero; remade many times
1955	Pather Panchali	Satyajit Ray	Subir Banerjee, Karuna Banerjee, Uma Dasgupta, Chunibala Devi	—	"Best Human Document", Cannes 1956; start of the Apu Trilogy
1958	Jalsaghar	Satyajit Ray	Chhabi Biswas	—	Elegy for a dying feudal world, set to classical music
1960	Meghe Dhaka Tara	Ritwik Ghatak	Supriya Choudhury, Anil Chatterjee	—	Partition trauma; ranked among India's greatest films
1964	Charulata	Satyajit Ray	Madhabi Mukherjee, Soumitra Chatterjee	—	Silver Bear for Best Director, Berlin 1965
1969	Goopy Gyne Bagha Byne	Satyajit Ray	Tapen Chatterjee, Rabi Ghosh	Long-running hit	Musical fantasy loved by children
1973	Ashani Sanket	Satyajit Ray	Soumitra Chatterjee, Babita	—	Golden Bear, Berlin 1973; the Bengal famine
1980	Akaler Sandhane	Mrinal Sen	Dhritiman Chatterjee, Smita Patil	—	Silver Bear, Berlin 1981
1994	Unishe April	Rituparno Ghosh	Aparna Sen, Debashree Roy	Hit	National Award Best Feature Film

☐ MOV-01.7 Marathi cinema

Films in Marathi, centred in Mumbai, Pune and Kolhapur. India's cinema began here (Phalke was Marathi), and Marathi films today are celebrated for their writing. **Tags:** #india #marathi #maharashtra

Film Register — Marathi cinema (landmark selection)

Year	Film	Director	Lead cast	Box office / reception	Awards and why it matters
1932	Ayodhyecha Raja	V. Shantaram	Durga Khote, Govindrao Tembe	—	First Marathi talkie (Prabhat; also made in Hindi)
1936	Sant Tukaram	Vishnupant Damle, S. Fattelal	Vishnupant Pagnis	Hit	Honoured at Venice 1937
1953	Shyamchi Aai	P. K. Atre	Madhav Vaze, Vanamala	—	First winner of the National Award for Best Feature Film
2004	Shwaas	Sandeep Sawant	Arun Nalawade, Ashwin Chitale	—	National Award Best Feature Film; India's Oscar entry
2009	Harishchandrachi Factory	Paresh Mokashi	Nandu Madhav, Vibhawari Deshpande	—	Story of Phalke making the first Indian film
2014	Court	Chaitanya Tamhane	Vira Sathidar	—	Venice Orizzonti award 2014; National Award Best Feature Film
2016	Sairat	Nagraj Manjule	Rinku Rajguru, Akash Thosar	Highest-grossing Marathi film at release	Caste and young love; remade as Dhadak

☐ MOV-01.8 Bhojpuri cinema

Films in Bhojpuri, made mainly in Mumbai and Patna for audiences in Bihar, eastern Uttar Pradesh, Jharkhand and the Bhojpuri diaspora (Mauritius, Fiji, Suriname, Trinidad). First film *Ganga Maiyya Tohe Piyari Chadhaibo* (1963, Kundan Kumar), encouraged by President Rajendra Prasad. Revived in the 2000s by *Sasura Bada Paisawala* (2004, Manoj Tiwari). Known for folk music, stars such as Ravi Kishan and Dinesh Lal Yadav "Nirahua", and debates over vulgarity in songs. **Tags:** #india #bhojpuri #bihar #up

☐ MOV-01.9 Other cinemas of East and North-east India

- ☐ **Odia (Ollywood)**: from Bhubaneswar and Cuttack; first film *Sita Bibaha* (1936, Mohan Sundar Deb Goswami); art-house master Nirad N. Mohapatra (*Maya Miriga*, 1984).
- ☐ **Assamese (Jollywood)**: from Guwahati; first film *Joymoti* (1935, Jyoti Prasad Agarwala, made at his own Chitraban studio); Bhabendra Nath Saikia, Jahnu Barua; Rima Das's *Village Rockstars* (2017) won the National Award and was India's Oscar entry.
- ☐ **Manipuri**: first feature *Matamgi Manipur* (1972, Deb Kumar Bose); Aribam Syam Sharma's *Imagi Ningthem* (1981) won the Grand Prix at the Nantes Three Continents Festival. After armed groups banned Hindi films (2000), Manipur grew its own digital film industry.
- ☐ **Khasi, Garo, Mizo, Naga, Kokborok, Bodo and Nepali-language cinemas**: small but rising industries; *Manik Raitong* (1984) was the first Khasi film.
- ☐ **Maithili, Magahi, Angika and Santali films**: *Kanyadan* (1965) is often cited as the first Maithili film; Santali cinema is growing in Jharkhand and Odisha.
- ☐ **Sikkimese and Darjeeling Nepali-language films** (link MOV-04.6 Nepal).

☐ MOV-01.10 Cinemas of West and North India

- ☐ **Gujarati (Dhollywood)**: first talkie *Narsinh Mehta* (1932, Nanubhai Vakil); revival after 2012; *Hellaro* (2019, Abhishek Shah) won the National Award for Best Feature Film; Pan Nalin's *Last Film Show* (*Chhello Show*, 2021) was India's Oscar entry and made the shortlist.
- ☐ **Punjabi (Pollywood)**: from Mohali, Chandigarh and Lahore before Partition; *Sheela* (*Pind di Kudi*, 1935) among the first; *Chann Pardesi* (1980) won a National Award; boom since *Jatt & Juliet* (2012) and *Carry On Jatta* (2012); stars Diljit Dosanjh, Gippy Grewal, Ammy Virk; huge Canadian diaspora market.
- ☐ **Rajasthani**: first film *Nazrana* (1942); hits such as *Bai Chali Sasariye* (1988); small but loved, with Marwari, Mewari and Hadoti dialects.
- ☐ **Haryanvi**: *Chandrawal* (1984) was a landmark rural hit; now growing on YouTube and streaming.
- ☐ **Garhwali and Kumaoni (Uttarakhand)**: *Jagwal* (1983, Parashar Gaur) is regarded as the first Garhwali film.
- ☐ **Kashmiri, Dogri and Ladakhi**: *Mehjoor* (1964) is often cited as the first Kashmiri film.
- ☐ **Chhattisgarhi (Chhollywood)**: *Kahi Debe Sandesh* (1965, Manu Nayak) was the first; revived after 2000 with *Mor Chhainha Bhuinya*.
- ☐ **Konkani**: *Mogacho Anvddo* (1950, Jerry Braganza); *Nachom-ia Kumpasar* (2014) a modern classic.
- ☐ **Sindhi**: *Abana* (1958) in India; Sindhi films also in Pakistan.
- ☐ **Sanskrit**: *Adi Shankaracharya* (1983, G. V. Iyer) was the first Sanskrit feature and won the National Award for Best Feature Film.

☐ MOV-01.11 Other South Indian cinemas

- ☐ **Tulu (Coastalwood)**: from Mangaluru and Udupi; first film *Enna Thangadi* (1971); *Kantara*'s world grew from this coast.
- ☐ **Kodava**: from Kodagu (Coorg); *Naada Mann Naada Koota* (1972) is cited as the first.
- ☐ **Beary, Badaga, Irula and other community-language films**: *Byari* (2011) won the National Award for Best Feature Film.

☐ MOV-01.12 Indian documentary, animation and independent cinema

- ☐ **Documentary**: Films Division (1948–2022, merged into NFDC), Anand Patwardhan, Deepa Dhanraj, the Oscar-winning short *The Elephant Whisperers* (2022, Kartiki Gonsalves, produced by Guneet Monga; Oscar 2023); *Writing with Fire* (Oscar-nominated, 2022); *All That Breathes* (Shaunak Sen; Cannes L'Œil d'or 2022).

☐ **Animation**: *Ek Anek Aur Ekta* (1974, Doordarshan short), *Ramayana: The Legend of Prince Rama* (1992, Indo-Japanese), *Hanuman* (2005), *Mahavatar Narsimha* (2025); Indian studios in global VFX (Prime Focus/DNEG, Red Chillies VFX).

☐ **Independent and festival cinema**: Payal Kapadia, Chaitanya Tamhane, Rima Das, Pan Nalin, Amit Masurkar, Kanu Behl; film institutes FTII (Pune, 1960) and SRFTI (Kolkata, 1995).

☐ **Short films and YouTube cinema**: a nursery for new talent in every language.

MOV-02 Cinema of the Americas

Before you start — MOV-02. From Hollywood, the most powerful film industry in history, to the Golden Age of Mexico, Brazil's Cinema Novo and Argentina's new cinema. **See also:** MOV-10.1 Oscars, MOV-09.4 Studio era, MOV-08 Movements.

☐ MOV-02.1 United States: Hollywood

The American film industry, centred in Los Angeles since the 1910s, the world's largest by revenue. Known for the studio and star systems, genre storytelling, blockbusters, franchises and global distribution. **Tags:** #usa #english #hollywood

☐ **The Big Five and Little Three (1920s–1948)**: MGM, Paramount, Warner Bros., 20th Century-Fox, RKO; Universal, Columbia, United Artists.

☐ **Classical Hollywood (1927–1960)**: invisible editing, three-act stories, the Production Code (1934–1968).

☐ **New Hollywood (1967–1980)**: Coppola, Scorsese, Spielberg, Lucas, Altman; the director as author.

☐ **Blockbuster era (1975–)**: *Jaws* (1975) and *Star Wars* (1977) created the summer blockbuster.

☐ **Franchises and cinematic universes (2008–)**: Marvel Cinematic Universe, DC, Pixar, Disney.

☐ **Streaming studios**: Netflix, Amazon MGM, Apple, now major producers.

Sub-industries and centres of American film

☐ **American independent cinema**: Sundance, Miramax, A24, Neon; John Cassavetes to the Safdie brothers.

☐ **New York cinema**: Woody Allen, Spike Lee, Martin Scorsese's city films.

☐ **Georgia / Atlanta ("Y'allywood")**: a production hub since tax incentives of 2008.

☐ **African-American cinema**: Oscar Micheaux's "race films" (1919–), Blaxploitation (1970s), Spike Lee, Ava DuVernay, Jordan Peele, Ryan Coogler.

☐ **Hispanic and Latino American film**, **Asian-American film** (*Everything Everywhere All at Once*, 2022), **Native American film** (*Smoke Signals*, 1998).

☐ **Faith-based, Christian films** and the Utah-based Latter-day Saint film scene.

☐ **Animation studios**: Disney, Pixar, DreamWorks, Laika, Sony Pictures Animation.

Film Register — Hollywood (landmark selection)

Year	Film	Director	Lead cast	Box office / reception	Awards and why it matters
1903	The Great Train Robbery	Edwin S. Porter	Justus D. Barnes	Huge nickelodeon hit	Early narrative editing; the first Western
1915	The Birth of a Nation	D. W. Griffith	Lillian Gish	Huge hit	Technically influential and openly racist; revived the Ku Klux Klan
1927	The Jazz Singer	Alan Crosland	Al Jolson	Hit	First feature with synchronised dialogue
1927	Wings	William A. Wellman	Clara Bow	—	First Academy Award for Best Picture ("Outstanding Picture")
1939	Gone with the Wind	Victor Fleming	Clark Gable, Vivien Leigh	Highest-grossing film adjusted for inflation	8 competitive Oscars; Hattie McDaniel, first Black Oscar winner
1939	The Wizard of Oz	Victor Fleming	Judy Garland	—	Technicolor fantasy; most-seen film in history (Library of Congress)
1941	Citizen Kane	Orson Welles	Orson Welles	Flop at release	Topped Sight and Sound

					critics' poll five decades in a row
1942	Casablanca	Michael Curtiz	Humphrey Bogart, Ingrid Bergman	Hit	Best Picture
1958	Vertigo	Alfred Hitchcock	James Stewart, Kim Novak	Mixed at release	Sight and Sound's greatest film (2012)
1959	Ben-Hur	William Wyler	Charlton Heston	Blockbuster	11 Oscars, a record later tied
1972	The Godfather	Francis Ford Coppola	Marlon Brando, Al Pacino	Blockbuster	Best Picture; New Hollywood peak
1975	Jaws	Steven Spielberg	Roy Scheider	First film to earn US$100 million in US rentals	Birth of the summer blockbuster
1977	Star Wars	George Lucas	Mark Hamill, Harrison Ford, Carrie Fisher	Record grosser	Changed effects (ILM) and merchandising
1997	Titanic	James Cameron	Leonardo DiCaprio, Kate Winslet	First film to pass US$1 billion worldwide	11 Oscars
2009	Avatar	James Cameron	Sam Worthington, Zoe Saldaña	About US$2.92 billion worldwide	3D revolution
2019	Avengers: Endgame	Anthony and Joe Russo	Robert Downey Jr., Chris Evans	About US$2.93 billion (after 2026 re-release)	Highest-grossing film of all time (as checked 5 Oct 2026)
2023	Oppenheimer	Christopher Nolan	Cillian Murphy	About US$975 million	7 Oscars including Best Picture
2025	One Battle After Another	Paul Thomas Anderson	Leonardo DiCaprio, Sean Penn	—	Best Picture, 98th Oscars (2026)

☐ MOV-02.2 Canada

English-language production in Toronto and Vancouver ("Hollywood North") and a distinct Québécois French cinema in Montreal. The National Film Board of Canada (1939) pioneered documentary and animation (Norman McLaren). Directors: David Cronenberg, Atom Egoyan, Denis Villeneuve, Xavier Dolan, Sarah Polley. **Tags:** #canada #english #french

☐ MOV-02.3 Mexico: the Golden Age and the "Three Amigos"

Mexico's **Época de Oro** (about 1936–1959) made it the leading Spanish-language film industry, with stars María Félix, Pedro Infante and Cantinflas, and director Emilio "El Indio" Fernández. Luis Buñuel made *Los Olvidados* (1950) here. Today: Alfonso Cuarón (*Roma*, 2018), Guillermo del Toro, Alejandro G. Iñárritu. Studios: Estudios Churubusco. Award: the Ariel. **Tags:** #mexico #spanish #latinamerica

Year	Film	Director	Lead cast	Box office / reception	Awards and why it matters
1936	Allá en el Rancho Grande	Fernando de Fuentes	Tito Guízar	Hit across Latin America	Launched the ranchera comedy and the Golden Age
1950	Los Olvidados	Luis Buñuel	Alfonso Mejía	—	Best Director, Cannes 1951
2000	Amores perros	Alejandro G. Iñárritu	Gael García Bernal	Hit	Oscar nomination; new Mexican cinema
2001	Y tu mamá también	Alfonso Cuarón	Gael García Bernal, Diego Luna	Hit	Road film icon
2018	Roma	Alfonso Cuarón	Yalitza Aparicio	Netflix	Golden Lion; Oscars for Director and Foreign Language Film

☐ MOV-02.4 Brazil: from chanchadas to Cinema Novo

Brazil's popular **chanchada** musical comedies (1930s–1950s), then **Cinema Novo** (1960s), "an idea in the head and a camera in the hand" (Glauber Rocha). Studios Vera Cruz and Atlântida; now Globo Filmes. Landmarks: *O Pagador de Promessas* (1962, Palme d'Or), *Central do Brasil* (1998, Golden Bear), *Cidade de Deus* (2002, Fernando Meirelles),

Ainda Estou Aqui (*I'm Still Here*, 2024, Walter Salles, Brazil's first Oscar for International Feature). **Tags:** #brazil #portuguese #latinamerica

☐ MOV-02.5 Argentina

One of Latin America's oldest industries (tango musicals of the 1930s with Carlos Gardel). The **New Argentine Cinema** of the 1990s: Lucrecia Martel, Pablo Trapero. Oscar winners *La historia oficial* (1985) and *El secreto de sus ojos* (2009). **Tags:** #argentina #spanish

☐ MOV-02.6 Chile, Colombia, Peru, Bolivia, Venezuela, Uruguay

☐ **Chile**: Patricio Guzmán (*The Battle of Chile*), Pablo Larraín, *Una mujer fantástica* (2017, Oscar).

☐ **Colombia**: Ciro Guerra's *Embrace of the Serpent* (2015, Oscar nomination), Víctor Gaviria.

☐ **Peru**: Claudia Llosa's *La teta asustada* (2009, Golden Bear).

☐ **Bolivia**: Jorge Sanjinés and Grupo Ukamau, cinema in Quechua and Aymara.

☐ **Venezuela** and **Uruguay**: *Desde allá* (2015, Golden Lion, Venezuela); *Whisky* (2004, Uruguay).

☐ MOV-02.7 Cuba and the Caribbean

☐ **Cuba**: ICAIC (founded 1959); Tomás Gutiérrez Alea (*Memories of Underdevelopment*, 1968; *Strawberry and Chocolate*, 1993); the Havana Film Festival (1979).

☐ **Jamaica**: *The Harder They Come* (1972), the film that took reggae to the world.

☐ **Puerto Rico, Dominican Republic, Haiti, Trinidad and Tobago**: growing industries; Haitian director Raoul Peck (*I Am Not Your Negro*, 2016).

MOV-03 Cinema of Europe

Before you start — MOV-03. Europe gave the world the first film shows and most of the great film movements. Learn each country's industry here and the movements in Part 3. **See also:** MOV-11 Festivals (Cannes, Venice, Berlin), MOV-08 Movements.

☐ MOV-03.1 France

The birthplace of public cinema (Lumière, Méliès, Pathé and Gaumont, the world's oldest film company still active, 1895). Poetic Realism (1930s), the **Nouvelle Vague** (1959–), and a state support system (CNC, 1946) that protects French film. Award: the César; festival: Cannes. **Tags:** #france #french

Year	Film	Director	Lead cast	Box office / reception	Awards and why it matters
1902	A Trip to the Moon (Le Voyage dans la Lune)	Georges Méliès	Georges Méliès	World hit (and pirated)	Founding work of fantasy and effects
1937	La Grande Illusion	Jean Renoir	Jean Gabin	—	Anti-war classic
1939	La Règle du jeu	Jean Renoir	Marcel Dalio	Flop, later canonised	Often ranked among the greatest films
1959	Les Quatre Cents Coups	François Truffaut	Jean-Pierre Léaud	—	Best Director, Cannes; opened the New Wave
1960	À bout de souffle	Jean-Luc Godard	Jean-Paul Belmondo, Jean Seberg	Hit	Jump cuts that rewrote editing
2001	Amélie	Jean-Pierre Jeunet	Audrey Tautou	International hit	Among the most successful French films abroad
2011	The Intouchables	Olivier Nakache, Éric Toledano	François Cluzet, Omar Sy	Among France's top grossers	Global hit, remade in India as *Oopiri/Thozha*
2023	Anatomy of a Fall	Justine Triet	Sandra Hüller	—	Palme d'Or; Oscar for Original Screenplay

☐ MOV-03.2 United Kingdom

British cinema: Ealing comedies, Hitchcock's British years, the Free Cinema and kitchen-sink realism, Hammer horror, James Bond (1962–), Merchant Ivory, Working Title. Studios: Pinewood, Shepperton, Leavesden (Harry Potter). Institutions: the BFI (1933), BAFTA. Directors: David Lean, Powell and Pressburger, Ken Loach, Mike Leigh, Danny Boyle, Christopher Nolan, Steve McQueen. **Tags:** #uk #english

☐ MOV-03.3 Italy

From the silent epic *Cabiria* (1914) to **Neorealism** (*Rome, Open City*, 1945; *Bicycle Thieves*, 1948), the art films of Fellini and Antonioni, **commedia all'italiana**, Sergio Leone's **spaghetti Westerns** and the **giallo** thrillers of Dario Argento. Cinecittà studios (1937). Award: David di Donatello; festival: Venice. **Tags:** #italy #italian

Year	Film	Director	Lead cast	Box office / reception	Awards and why it matters
1914	Cabiria	Giovanni Pastrone	Bartolomeo Pagano	International hit	Epic sets and tracking shots influenced Griffith
1948	Bicycle Thieves (Ladri di biciclette)	Vittorio De Sica	Lamberto Maggiorani	—	Honorary Oscar; peak of Neorealism
1960	La Dolce Vita	Federico Fellini	Marcello Mastroianni, Anita Ekberg	Hit	Palme d'Or; gave the world the word "paparazzi"
1966	The Good, the Bad and the Ugly	Sergio Leone	Clint Eastwood	World hit	Spaghetti Western classic; Ennio Morricone's score
1988	Cinema Paradiso	Giuseppe Tornatore	Philippe Noiret, Salvatore Cascio	—	Oscar for Foreign Language Film; love letter to cinema
1997	Life Is Beautiful	Roberto Benigni	Roberto Benigni	International hit	Three Oscars including Best Actor

☐ MOV-03.4 Germany and Austria

German Expressionism (*The Cabinet of Dr. Caligari*, 1920; *Metropolis*, 1927) and the giant UFA studio; Leni Riefenstahl and Nazi propaganda; post-war DEFA in East Germany; the **New German Cinema** (Fassbinder, Herzog, Wenders, Schlöndorff); contemporary: *The Lives of Others* (2006), Christian Petzold, Maren Ade. Austria: Michael Haneke, Ulrich Seidl. **Tags:** #germany #austria #german

☐ MOV-03.5 Spain and Portugal

- ☐ **Spain**: Luis Buñuel, Luis García Berlanga, Carlos Saura; Pedro Almodóvar and the Movida; Guillermo del Toro's Spanish films; award: the Goya (1987).
- ☐ **Portugal**: Manoel de Oliveira (directed until past 100), Pedro Costa, Miguel Gomes.

☐ MOV-03.6 Nordic cinema

- ☐ **Sweden**: Victor Sjöström and the silent golden age; Ingmar Bergman (*The Seventh Seal*, 1957); Roy Andersson; Ruben Östlund (two Palmes d'Or).
- ☐ **Denmark**: Carl Theodor Dreyer; Lars von Trier and **Dogme 95**; Thomas Vinterberg (*Another Round*, Oscar 2021).
- ☐ **Norway**: Joachim Trier (*Sentimental Value*, Oscar for International Feature 2026).
- ☐ **Finland**: Aki Kaurismäki. **Iceland**: Baltasar Kormákur.

☐ MOV-03.7 Russia and the Soviet Union

Soviet **montage** cinema of the 1920s (Eisenstein's *Battleship Potemkin*, 1925; Dziga Vertov's *Man with a Movie Camera*, 1929; Pudovkin, Kuleshov), Mosfilm (1923), Socialist Realism, the Thaw (*The Cranes Are Flying*, Palme d'Or 1958), Andrei Tarkovsky (*Andrei Rublev*, *Solaris*, *Stalker*), Sergei Bondarchuk's *War and Peace* (Oscar 1969), Nikita Mikhalkov, Andrey Zvyagintsev (*Leviathan*; Grand Prix Cannes 2026 for *Minotaur*). Soviet audiences adored Raj Kapoor and Mithun Chakraborty. **Tags:** #russia #ussr #russian

☐ MOV-03.8 Central and Eastern Europe

☐ **Poland**: the Polish School (Andrzej Wajda), Roman Polański, Krzysztof Kieślowski (*Three Colours*), Paweł Pawlikowski (*Ida*, Oscar 2015); Łódź Film School.

☐ **Czech Republic and Slovakia**: the Czechoslovak New Wave (Miloš Forman, Věra Chytilová, Jiří Menzel's *Closely Watched Trains*, Oscar 1968); Jan Švankmajer's animation; Karlovy Vary festival.

☐ **Hungary**: Miklós Jancsó, Béla Tarr, István Szabó, László Nemes (*Son of Saul*, Oscar 2016).

☐ **Romania**: the **Romanian New Wave** (2000s): Cristi Puiu, Cristian Mungiu (Palmes d'Or 2007 and 2026), Corneliu Porumboiu, Radu Jude.

☐ **Former Yugoslavia, Bulgaria, Greece (Theo Angelopoulos, Yorgos Lanthimos and the Greek Weird Wave), Georgia (Sergei Parajanov, Otar Iosseliani), Armenia, Ukraine (Alexander Dovzhenko), the Baltic states.**

☐ MOV-03.9 Belgium, Netherlands, Ireland, Switzerland

The Dardenne brothers (two Palmes d'Or, Belgium), Chantal Akerman (*Jeanne Dielman*, Sight and Sound's greatest film, 2022), Paul Verhoeven (Netherlands), Irish cinema (*The Banshees of Inisherin*, Cartoon Saloon's animation), Swiss director Jean-Luc Godard's later years.

MOV-04 Cinema of Asia (beyond India)

Before you start — MOV-04. Asia makes the majority of the world's films. East Asia's industries (China, Japan, Korea) rival Hollywood at home; South and West Asia have proud old traditions; Southeast Asia is the fastest-growing region.

☐ MOV-04.1 Japan

One of the oldest and most self-sufficient industries, with studios Shochiku, Nikkatsu, Toho (Godzilla, 1954), Daiei and Toei. Golden age of the 1950s: Akira Kurosawa, Yasujirō Ozu, Kenji Mizoguchi, Mikio Naruse. Also **anime** (Studio Ghibli, Toei Animation), **kaiju** monster films, **J-horror** (*Ringu*, 1998), jidaigeki samurai films. **Tags:** #japan #japanese #anime

Year	Film	Director	Lead cast	Box office / reception	Awards and why it matters
1950	Rashomon	Akira Kurosawa	Toshirō Mifune, Machiko Kyō	—	Golden Lion 1951: opened the West to Japanese cinema
1953	Tokyo Story	Yasujirō Ozu	Chishū Ryū, Setsuko Hara	—	Topped Sight and Sound directors' poll (2012)
1954	Seven Samurai	Akira Kurosawa	Toshirō Mifune, Takashi Shimura	Hit	Template for the team-on-a-mission film (and Sholay's inspiration)
1954	Godzilla (Gojira)	Ishirō Honda	Akira Takarada	Hit	Nuclear-age monster; longest-running film franchise
2001	Spirited Away	Hayao Miyazaki	(voices) Rumi Hiiragi	Japan's top grosser for nearly two decades	Golden Bear 2002; Oscar for Animated Feature
2020	Demon Slayer: Mugen Train	Haruo Sotozaki	(voices) Natsuki Hanae	Japan's highest-grossing film	Anime's box-office power
2023	Godzilla Minus One	Takashi Yamazaki	Ryunosuke Kamiki	International hit	Oscar for Visual Effects: first for a Japanese film

☐ MOV-04.2 China, Hong Kong and Taiwan

☐ **Mainland China**: Shanghai's golden age (1930s); Communist-era studios; the **Fifth Generation** (Zhang Yimou, Chen Kaige: *Farewell My Concubine*, Palme d'Or 1993); the Sixth Generation (Jia Zhangke); today the world's second-largest box office market; record hits *The Battle at Lake Changjin* (2021) and *Ne Zha 2* (2025, the highest-grossing animated film worldwide).

☐ **Hong Kong**: Shaw Brothers and Golden Harvest, **kung fu** and **wuxia** films, Bruce Lee, Jackie Chan, John Woo's "heroic bloodshed", Wong Kar-wai (*In the Mood for Love*, 2000), Hong Kong Film Awards.

☐ **Taiwan**: the Taiwan New Cinema (Hou Hsiao-hsien, Edward Yang), Ang Lee (*Crouching Tiger*, *Hidden Dragon*, 2000), Tsai Ming-liang; the Golden Horse Awards.

Tags: #china #hongkong #taiwan #chinese #mandarin #cantonese

☐ MOV-04.3 South Korea (and North Korea)

South Korea's cinema rose after the end of military censorship (1990s) with screen quotas and chaebol investment: Park Chan-wook (*Oldboy*, 2003), Bong Joon-ho (*Parasite*, 2019: Palme d'Or and the first non-English Best Picture Oscar), Lee Chang-dong, Hong Sang-soo, Kim Ki-duk; the record hit *The Admiral: Roaring Currents* (2014). Awards: Blue Dragon, Grand Bell; festival: Busan. North Korea has a state industry, Korean Feature Film Studio. **Tags:** #southkorea #korean #hallyu

☐ MOV-04.4 Pakistan (Lollywood)

Urdu and Punjabi films centred in Lahore ("Lollywood"), with a golden age in the 1960s, decline in the 1980s–1990s, and revival since *Khuda Kay Liye* (2007). Pashto films from Peshawar ("Pollywood"), Sindhi films from Karachi. Landmarks: *Jago Hua Savera* (1959), *Bol* (2011), *The Legend of Maula Jatt* (2022, Pakistan's highest-grossing film), *Joyland* (2022, Cannes Un Certain Regard Jury Prize). **Tags:** #pakistan #urdu #punjabi #lollywood

☐ MOV-04.5 Bangladesh (Dhallywood)

Bengali-language films from Dhaka ("Dhallywood"). First feature *Mukh O Mukhosh* (1956, Abdul Jabbar Khan); Zahir Raihan's *Jibon Theke Neya* (1970); Tareque Masud's *Matir Moina* (2002, FIPRESCI Prize, Cannes); Mostofa Sarwar Farooki. **Tags:** #bangladesh #bengali

☐ MOV-04.6 Nepal, Sri Lanka, Bhutan, Afghanistan, Maldives

☐ **Nepal**: Nepali films from Kathmandu ("Kollywood"); *Kalo Pothi* (2015); *Elephants in the Fog* (Jury Prize, Un Certain Regard, Cannes 2026).

☐ **Sri Lanka**: Sinhala cinema; Lester James Peries (*Rekava*, 1956), Prasanna Vithanage; Tamil films of Sri Lanka.

☐ **Bhutan**: Khyentse Norbu (*The Cup*, 1999), Pawo Choyning Dorji (*Lunana*, Oscar nomination 2022).

☐ **Afghanistan**: Siddiq Barmak's *Osama* (2003, Golden Globe); filmmakers in exile.

☐ **Maldives**: small Dhivehi-language industry.

☐ MOV-04.7 Iran (Persian cinema)

Iranian cinema grew from the popular "Film Farsi" before 1979 and the **Iranian New Wave** (Dariush Mehrjui's *The Cow*, 1969), and after the revolution produced masters despite censorship: Abbas Kiarostami (*Taste of Cherry*, Palme d'Or 1997), Mohsen Makhmalbaf, Majid Majidi (*Children of Heaven*, Oscar nomination), Jafar Panahi (Golden Bear 2015, Palme d'Or 2025 for *It Was Just an Accident*), Asghar Farhadi (two Oscars: *A Separation*, *The Salesman*). Fajr Film Festival. **Tags:** #iran #persian #farsi

☐ MOV-04.8 Turkey (Yeşilçam)

Turkish popular cinema of the **Yeşilçam** era (1950s–1980s), named after a street in Istanbul, made up to about 300 films a year. Masters: Yılmaz Güney (*Yol*, Palme d'Or 1982), Nuri Bilge Ceylan (*Winter Sleep*, Palme d'Or 2014), Ferzan Özpetek. Turkish TV dramas (dizi) are now global. Berlin's 2026 Golden Bear went to İlker Çatak's Turkish-language *Yellow Letters*. **Tags:** #turkey #turkish

☐ MOV-04.9 The Arab world and Israel

☐ **Egypt ("Hollywood on the Nile")**: Studio Misr (1935); the Arab world's biggest industry; Youssef Chahine (Cannes 50th Anniversary Prize, 1997); star Omar Sharif; singer-stars Umm Kulthum and Abdel Halim Hafez; Cairo festival (1976).

☐ **Lebanon**: Nadine Labaki (*Capernaum*, 2018, Cannes Jury Prize), Ziad Doueiri.

☐ **Palestine**: Elia Suleiman, Hany Abu-Assad (*Paradise Now*, *Omar*).

☐ **Saudi Arabia**: Haifaa al-Mansour (*Wadjda*, 2012), cinemas reopened in 2018; Red Sea festival (2021).

☐ *Syria, Iraq, Jordan* (Theeb), *Morocco, Tunisia, Algeria (Maghreb cinema, MOV-05.1)*, the Gulf states.

☐ **Israel**: Hebrew-language cinema; *Waltz with Bashir* (2008), *Foxtrot* (2017), festivals in Jerusalem and Haifa.

☐ MOV-04.10 Central Asia and the Caucasus

Kazakhstan (the Kazakh New Wave, Darezhan Omirbayev), Kyrgyzstan (Aktan Arym Kubat), Uzbekistan (Uzbekfilm), Tajikistan, Mongolia; Georgia and Armenia (in MOV-03.8).

☐ MOV-04.11 Southeast Asia

☐ **Philippines**: the golden age of the 1950s studios (LVN, Sampaguita), the second golden age of the 1970s (Lino Brocka, Ishmael Bernal), Lav Diaz (Golden Lion 2016), Brillante Mendoza; Metro Manila Film Festival.

☐ **Indonesia**: Usmar Ismail, "father of Indonesian film" (*Darah dan Doa*, 1950, whose shooting day is National Film Day); horror boom; Joko Anwar; *The Raid* (2011, made with Welsh director Gareth Evans).

☐ **Thailand**: Apichatpong Weerasethakul (*Uncle Boonmee*, Palme d'Or 2010), *Ong-Bak* (Tony Jaa), *How to Make Millions Before Grandma Dies* (2024, a regional hit).

☐ **Vietnam**: Trần Anh Hùng (*The Scent of Green Papaya*), a fast-growing box office.

☐ **Malaysia, Singapore (Anthony Chen, Eric Khoo), Cambodia (Rithy Panh), Myanmar, Laos.**

MOV-05 Cinema of Africa and Oceania

Before you start — MOV-05. Africa has the world's fastest-growing film culture, from Nollywood's volume to the art cinema of Senegal, Mali and Burkina Faso, and FESPACO, Africa's biggest festival. Oceania adds Australia, New Zealand and Pacific voices.

☐ MOV-05.1 North Africa (the Maghreb and Egypt)

Algeria's *Chronicle of the Years of Fire* (1975, Mohammed Lakhdar-Hamina: Palme d'Or, the first for an African film); Tunisia's Moufida Tlatli and the Carthage Film Festival (1966, Africa's and the Arab world's oldest festival); Morocco's Ouarzazate studios, where many Hollywood epics are shot (Egypt: MOV-04.9).

☐ MOV-05.2 West Africa: Nollywood, Ghallywood and Francophone cinema

☐ **Nigeria (Nollywood)**: born with the home-video drama *Living in Bondage* (1992, Chris Obi Rapu); now one of the world's largest producers by volume; English, Yoruba, Igbo and Hausa (Kannywood, from Kano) films; landmarks *The Wedding Party* (2016), *Lionheart* (2018), *King of Boys*, *A Tribe Called Judah* (2023, box-office record). Award: AMVCA and AMAA.

☐ **Ghana (Ghallywood)** and the Twi-language "Kumawood".

☐ **Senegal**: Ousmane Sembène, "father of African cinema" (*Black Girl*, 1966), Djibril Diop Mambéty (*Touki Bouki*, 1973), Mati Diop (*Atlantics*, Cannes Grand Prix 2019; *Dahomey*, Golden Bear 2024).

☐ **Mali and Burkina Faso**: Souleymane Cissé (*Yeelen*, 1987, Cannes Jury Prize), Idrissa Ouédraogo; FESPACO in Ouagadougou (1969).

☐ **Mauritania**: Abderrahmane Sissako (*Timbuktu*, 2014). **Côte d'Ivoire, Cameroon, Niger.**

☐ MOV-05.3 East and Southern Africa

☐ **South Africa**: *Tsotsi* (2005, Oscar for Foreign Language Film), *District 9* (2009); Cape Town studios.

☐ **Kenya** ("Riverwood"), **Tanzania** ("Bongo" films), **Uganda** (Wakaliwood's micro-budget action, Ramon Film Productions), **Ethiopia** (Haile Gerima), **Rwanda**, **Zimbabwe**, **Somalia**, **Sudan** (*Goodbye Julia*, 2023).

☐ MOV-05.4 Australia, New Zealand and the Pacific

☐ **Australia**: *The Story of the Kelly Gang* (1906), often called the world's first feature-length narrative film; the **Australian New Wave** of the 1970s (Peter Weir, *Picnic at Hanging Rock*; George Miller, *Mad Max*); Baz Luhrmann; Indigenous filmmakers Warwick Thornton, Rachel Perkins; AACTA Awards.

☐ **New Zealand**: Jane Campion (*The Piano*, Palme d'Or 1993, the first by a woman director), Peter Jackson (*The Lord of the Rings*, Weta), Taika Waititi; Māori cinema (*Whale Rider*, 2002).

☐ **Pacific Islands**: Fiji, Samoa, Papua New Guinea, Hawaiian films; *Tanna* (2015, Vanuatu, Oscar nomination).

☐ MOV-05.5 Diaspora and transnational cinemas

Films made by migrant communities between two homelands: Indian diaspora cinema (Mira Nair, Gurinder Chadha's *Bend It Like Beckham*, Deepa Mehta's *Elements Trilogy*), Black British cinema, Beur cinema in France, Turkish-German cinema (Fatih Akin), Chinese diaspora films (*Crazy Rich Asians*), and global co-productions.

☐ MOV-05.6 How the registers grow

The landmark registers above are the trunk. On the website each industry will grow a **complete year-wise register** in this order: (1) every award-winning and nominated film from the official award databases (MOV-10 to MOV-12); (2) every film in national archives and catalogues (NFAI/NFDC for India, Library of Congress for the USA, BFI for the UK, CNC for France, and their equivalents); (3) every film with an entry in Wikidata (which links to IMDb and national IDs), filtered by country of origin and original language, sorted by year of first release. Each row keeps the same fields as above, plus language, runtime, certificate and streaming availability (dated). Box-office data will come only from named trade sources and will always say gross or net, domestic or worldwide, and the date.

PART 2 — GENRES, FORMS AND FORMATS

About this Part. The second great classification: what kind of film it is. A genre is a family of films that share a promise to the audience (a thriller promises suspense; a comedy promises laughter). Most films belong to more than one genre. Each entry gives one or two lines and example films from different countries, so you can compare India with the world.

MOV-06 Film genres and sub-genres

Before you start — MOV-06. Twenty genre families, each with its sub-genres. Use it to find the kind of film you love, then jump to the industries (Part 1) that make it best. **See also:** BOK genre fiction (shared roots), MUS-film scores.

☐ MOV-06.1 Drama

Films that take real human problems seriously, aiming at emotion and truth more than thrills. Examples: *Pather Panchali* (India), *Tokyo Story* (Japan), *A Separation* (Iran). **Tags:** #drama

- ☐ **Family drama**: the joys and fights of families; *Hum Aapke Hain Koun..!*, *Kapoor & Sons*, *Shoplifters* (Japan).
- ☐ **Social drama / social problem film**: films that question an injustice; *Do Bigha Zamin*, *Article 15*, *Jai Bhim*.
- ☐ **Melodrama**: heightened emotion, clear good and evil, big music; *Mother India*, Douglas Sirk's *All That Heaven Allows*.
- ☐ **Coming-of-age**: growing up; *The 400 Blows*, *Udaan*, *Boyhood*.
- ☐ **Legal and courtroom drama**: *12 Angry Men*, *Jolly LLB*, *Court*, *Anatomy of a Fall*.
- ☐ **Political drama**: power and its abuse; *Z* (Costa-Gavras), *Raajneeti*, *Garm Hava*.
- ☐ **Medical, sports, workplace and school dramas**: *Chak De! India*, *Dangal*, *Taare Zameen Par*, *Rocky*, *Moneyball*.
- ☐ **Slice-of-life**: ordinary days without a big plot; Ozu, Hrishikesh Mukherjee's middle cinema, *Paterson*.
- ☐ **Tragedy**: a fall that feels inevitable; *Devdas*, *Kaagaz Ke Phool*, *Raging Bull*.

☐ MOV-06.2 Comedy

Films built to make us laugh, from slapstick to satire. **Tags:** #comedy

- ☐ **Slapstick and physical comedy**: Chaplin, Keaton, Mehmood, Jagdeep; *Andaz Apna Apna*.
- ☐ **Romantic comedy (rom-com)**: *It Happened One Night*, *Chupke Chupke*, *When Harry Met Sally...*, *Jab We Met*.
- ☐ **Screwball comedy**: fast talk and battles of the sexes (1930s Hollywood).
- ☐ **Satire**: laughter that attacks folly; *Dr. Strangelove*, *Jaane Bhi Do Yaaro*, *Peepli Live*.
- ☐ **Black (dark) comedy**: humour about death and crime; *Fargo*, *Delhi Belly*, *Andhadhun* (thriller-comedy).
- ☐ **Parody and spoof**: *Airplane!*, *Om Shanti Om* (homage-parody).
- ☐ **Comedy of errors and mistaken identity**: *Angoor* (from Shakespeare), *Hera Pheri*.
- ☐ **Situational and middle-class comedy**: Hrishikesh Mukherjee (*Golmaal*, 1979), Basu Chatterjee.
- ☐ **Stand-up and sketch films, mockumentary**: *This Is Spinal Tap*.

☐ MOV-06.3 Action

Films driven by physical conflict, stunts and spectacle. **Tags:** #action

- ☐ **Martial arts**: *Enter the Dragon*, *Crouching Tiger*, *Hidden Dragon*, *The Raid*.
- ☐ **Mass / masala action (India)**: the hero who defeats fifty men; *Baashha*, *Pokiri*, *K.G.F*, *Pushpa*.
- ☐ **Cop and buddy-cop**: *Lethal Weapon*, *Singham*, *Zanjeer*.
- ☐ **Heist and caper**: *Ocean's Eleven*, *Dhoom*, *Special 26*.
- ☐ **Disaster**: *The Towering Inferno*, *Titanic* (in part), *2018* (Malayalam flood film).
- ☐ **Spy and espionage action**: James Bond, *Mission: Impossible*, *Ek Tha Tiger*, *Baby*.
- ☐ **Superhero**: *Superman* (1978), *The Dark Knight*, Marvel films, *Krrish*, *Minnal Murali*.
- ☐ **Gun-fu and "heroic bloodshed"**: John Woo, *John Wick*.

☐ **Car and chase films**: *Bullitt*, *Fast & Furious*, *Mad Max: Fury Road*.

☐ MOV-06.4 Adventure

Journeys to unknown places, quests and treasure. *Raiders of the Lost Ark*, *Lawrence of Arabia*, *Life of Pi*, *Kantara* (folk adventure). Sub-genres: **swashbuckler** (pirates and swords), **jungle and survival adventure** (*The Revenant*, *Manjummel Boys*), **lost world**, **treasure hunt**, **sea adventure**. **Tags:** #adventure

☐ MOV-06.5 Thriller and suspense

Films that keep us anxious about what happens next. **Tags:** #thriller

☐ **Psychological thriller**: *Psycho*, *Black Swan*, *Raat*.

☐ **Crime thriller**: *Heat*, *Drishyam*, *Vikram Vedha*.

☐ **Political and conspiracy thriller**: *All the President's Men*, *Madras Cafe*.

☐ **Erotic thriller**, **legal thriller**, **techno-thriller**, **survival thriller** (*Buried*).

☐ **Revenge thriller**: *Oldboy*, *Kill Bill*, *Badlapur*.

☐ **Serial-killer and investigative thriller**: *The Silence of the Lambs*, *Memories of Murder*, *Ratsasan*.

☐ **Hitchcockian suspense**: the bomb under the table that the audience knows about.

☐ MOV-06.6 Crime and gangster

The world of criminals, police and justice. *The Godfather*, *Goodfellas*, *Nayakan*, *Satya*, *Gangs of Wasseypur*, *City of God*, Hong Kong triad films (*Infernal Affairs*). Sub-genres: **film noir** (1940s–1950s shadowy crime films: *Double Indemnity*; neo-noir: *Chinatown*, *Johnny Gaddaar*), **mafia/underworld**, **prison films**, **detective and whodunit** (*Knives Out*, *Byomkesh Bakshy!*), **police procedural**. **Tags:** #crime #noir

☐ MOV-06.7 Horror

Films that make us afraid, and let us enjoy it. **Tags:** #horror

☐ **Supernatural and ghost**: *The Exorcist*, *Mahal* (1949), *Bhoot*, *Ringu*.

☐ **Folk horror**: horror rooted in village belief; *The Wicker Man*, *Tumbbad*, *Bulbbul*.

☐ **Slasher**: a masked killer; *Halloween*, *Scream*.

☐ **Monster and creature**: *Frankenstein*, *Godzilla*, *Jaws*.

☐ **Zombie**: *Night of the Living Dead*, *Train to Busan*, *Go Goa Gone* (zom-com).

☐ **Psychological horror**: *The Shining*, *Hereditary*.

☐ **Body horror**: David Cronenberg, *The Substance*.

☐ **Found footage**: *The Blair Witch Project*, *Paranormal Activity*.

☐ **Horror-comedy**: *Stree*, *Bhool Bhulaiyaa*, *Shaun of the Dead*.

☐ **Ramsay Brothers horror (India, 1970s–1990s)**: *Purana Mandir*, *Veerana*.

☐ **J-horror, K-horror, Thai and Indonesian horror**: regional schools of fear.

☐ MOV-06.8 Science fiction

Stories about science, the future, space and "what if". **Tags:** #scifi

☐ **Space opera**: *Star Wars*, *Dune*.

☐ **Hard science fiction**: *2001: A Space Odyssey*, *Interstellar*, *The Martian*.

☐ **Dystopian and post-apocalyptic**: *Metropolis*, *Blade Runner*, *Mad Max*.

☐ **Cyberpunk**: *Blade Runner*, *Ghost in the Shell*, *The Matrix*.

☐ **Time travel**: *Back to the Future*, *Primer*, *Aditya 369* (Telugu, 1991), *Indru Netru Naalai*.

☐ **Alien contact**: *Close Encounters of the Third Kind*, *Arrival*, *Koi... Mil Gaya*, *PK*.

☐ **Robots and AI**: *Ex Machina*, *Enthiran*, *Her*.

☐ **Mythological science fiction (India)**: *Kalki 2898 AD*.

☐ MOV-06.9 Fantasy

Magic, myth and impossible worlds. *The Wizard of Oz*, *The Lord of the Rings*, *Pan's Labyrinth*, *Spirited Away*, *Baahubali*, *Mayabazar*. Sub-genres: **high/epic fantasy**, **fairy tale**, **magical realism** (*Amélie*, *Paheli*), **sword and sorcery**, **urban fantasy**. **Tags:** #fantasy

☐ MOV-06.10 Mythological and devotional (India's oldest genre)

Films from the epics, Puranas and saints' lives; the first genre of Indian cinema. *Raja Harishchandra*, *Sant Tukaram*, *Mayabazar*, *Jai Santoshi Maa* (1975, a surprise blockbuster), *Adipurush*, *Hanu-Man*. Also **saint films** (bhakti biopics), **Christian, Islamic and Buddhist religious films** worldwide (*The Ten Commandments*, *The Message*). **Tags:** #mythology #devotional #india

☐ MOV-06.11 Romance

Love stories in every shape. *Casablanca*, *Barsaat*, *Bobby*, *DDLJ*, *In the Mood for Love*, *Premam*, *96*. Sub-genres: **tragic romance** (*Ek Duuje Ke Liye*), **romantic drama**, **period romance**, **love triangle**, **star-crossed lovers** (Laila–Majnu, Heer–Ranjha films), **LGBTQ+ romance** (*Brokeback Mountain*, *Call Me by Your Name*, *Badhaai Do*). **Tags:** #romance

☐ MOV-06.12 Musical and dance

Films in which songs and dance carry the story. Hollywood musicals (*Singin' in the Rain*, *The Sound of Music*, *La La Land*), Indian films (almost all popular Indian films use songs; full musicals like *Sangam* era dance films, *Disco Dancer*, *ABCD*), **jukebox musicals** (*Mamma Mia!*), **dance films** (*Saturday Night Fever*, *Step Up*), **opera films** and **concert films**. **Tags:** #musical #dance

☐ MOV-06.13 Historical and period

Films set in the past. **Tags:** #history #period

- ☐ **Historical epic**: *Ben-Hur*, *Mughal-e-Azam*, *Jodhaa Akbar*, *Ponniyin Selvan*.
- ☐ **Biographical (biopic)**: *Gandhi*, *Bhaag Milkha Bhaag*, *Oppenheimer*, *Sardar Udham*.
- ☐ **Costume drama**: *Pride & Prejudice*, *Umrao Jaan*.
- ☐ **Freedom-struggle films (India)**: *Shaheed* (1965), *Lagaan*, *RRR*.
- ☐ **Partition films**: *Garm Hava*, *Tamas*, *Pinjar*, *Meghe Dhaka Tara*.
- ☐ **Samurai (jidaigeki)** and **wuxia (martial chivalry)** period films.

☐ MOV-06.14 War

Films about battles, soldiers and the cost of war. *All Quiet on the Western Front* (1930 and 2022), *Saving Private Ryan*, *Come and See*, *Haqeeqat* (1964), *Border*, *Uri: The Surgical Strike*, *1917*. Sub-genres: **anti-war film**, **combat film**, **war epic**, **home-front drama**, **Holocaust film** (*Schindler's List*), **military biopic** (*Shershaah*). **Tags:** #war

☐ MOV-06.15 Western (and its world cousins)

The American frontier: cowboys, outlaws, sheriffs. *Stagecoach*, *The Searchers*, *High Noon*, *Unforgiven*. Cousins: the Italian **spaghetti Western**, India's **curry Western** and dacoit films (*Sholay*, *Mera Gaon Mera Desh*, *Paan Singh Tomar*), the Australian **meat-pie Western**, the **Ostern** (Eastern European and Soviet "Red Westerns"). **Tags:** #western

☐ MOV-06.16 Animation (as a genre)

Films made frame by frame with drawings, models or computers (also a form: MOV-07.3). Family films (*Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs*, 1937, the first full-length cel-animated feature in colour; *Toy Story*, 1995, the first fully computer-animated feature), **anime**, **adult animation** (*Persepolis*), **stop-motion** (*Coraline*), Indian animation (*Hanuman*, *Mahavatar Narsimha*). **Tags:** #animation

☐ MOV-06.17 Family and children's films

Films made for children or the whole family. *E.T.*, *Paddington*, *Children of Heaven*, *Makdee*, *Chillar Party*, the Children's Film Society India (CFSI, 1955). **Tags:** #family #kids

☐ MOV-06.18 Sports films

Films around a game or athlete. *Rocky*, *Raging Bull*, *Chak De! India*, *Lagaan*, *Dangal*, *Iqbal*, *83*, *Ford v Ferrari*. **Tags:** #sports · **See also:** SPT

☐ MOV-06.19 Mystery and detective

Puzzle films that ask "who did it?". *Rashomon* (truth itself is the mystery), *Murder on the Orient Express*, *Kahaani*, *Talaash*, Satyajit Ray's Feluda films (*Sonar Kella*). **Tags:** #mystery

☐ MOV-06.20 Experimental genres and hybrids

☐ **Road movie**: *Easy Rider*, *Y tu mamá también*, *Piku*, *Highway*.
☐ **Survival film**: *Cast Away*, *127 Hours*.
☐ **Mockumentary and pseudo-documentary**.
☐ **Anthology film**: several stories in one; *Bombay Talkies* (2013), *Lust Stories*, *Paris, je t'aime*.
☐ **Hyperlink cinema**: crossing storylines; *Pulp Fiction*, *Life in a... Metro*, *Super Deluxe*.
☐ **Slow cinema**: long takes, little plot; Béla Tarr, Lav Diaz, Tsai Ming-liang.
☐ **Social-media and "screenlife" films**: told on screens; *Searching* (2018), *CTRL* (2024).
☐ **Masala film**: India's mix-of-all-genres format, serving every rasa in one film (MOV-00.07).

MOV-07 Forms, formats and audiences

Before you start — MOV-07. Genre says what a film is about; form says how it is made and shown. **See also:** MOV-16 Technology.

☐ MOV-07.1 By length

☐ **Feature film**: over 40 minutes by the Academy's rule (many festivals use 60 minutes or more); typically 90 to 180 minutes.
☐ **Short film**: under about 40 minutes; festival favourite (Clermont-Ferrand).
☐ **Micro-short and vertical short**: under a few minutes, made for phones.

☐ MOV-07.2 Documentary and non-fiction

Films about real people and events. Robert Flaherty's *Nanook of the North* (1922), Dziga Vertov, John Grierson (who coined "documentary" in 1926), **cinéma vérité**, **direct cinema**, **observational**, **participatory**, **essay film** (Chris Marker), **nature documentary** (David Attenborough's series), **investigative documentary**, **docudrama**; Indian: Anand Patwardhan, *The Elephant Whisperers*. **Tags:** #documentary

☐ MOV-07.3 Animation techniques

Hand-drawn (cel), stop-motion (clay/claymation, puppet, cut-out), computer-generated (3D CGI), rotoscope, motion capture, paint-on-glass, sand animation, pixilation, limited animation (anime), 2.5D. Pioneers: Émile Cohl (*Fantasmagorie*, 1908), Winsor McCay (*Gertie the Dinosaur*, 1914), Lotte Reiniger (silhouette feature *The Adventures of Prince Achmed*, 1926), Ram Mohan ("father of Indian animation").

☐ MOV-07.4 Experimental and avant-garde

Films that break story and form: surrealist (*Un Chien Andalou*, 1929), abstract (Oskar Fischinger, Norman McLaren), structural film, video art, Indian experimental cinema (Mani Kaul, Kumar Shahani, Amit Dutta).

☐ MOV-07.5 By technology and screen

Silent, sound, black-and-white, colour (Technicolor, 1930s), widescreen (CinemaScope, 1953), 3D (1950s craze; *Avatar* 2009; India's *My Dear Kuttichathan*, 1984, the first Indian 3D film), IMAX (1970), 70 mm, high frame rate, 4DX, VR cinema, interactive film.

☐ MOV-07.6 By release channel

Theatrical, festival, direct-to-video (Nollywood's origin), television film, streaming original (OTT), web series (episodic, a neighbour of film), YouTube cinema.

☐ MOV-07.7 By audience and certificate

India's CBFC certificates: **U** (all), **U/A 7+, U/A 13+, U/A 16+** (parental guidance by age, from 2024), **A** (adults), **S** (special audiences). USA (MPA): G, PG, PG-13, R, NC-17. UK (BBFC): U, PG, 12A, 15, 18. Each country has its own system (MOV-17.3).

☐ MOV-07.8 By budget and production model

Blockbuster/tentpole, mid-budget, low-budget/independent, micro-budget, B-movie, art-house, crowd-funded (*Manthan*, 1976, funded by 500,000 farmers paying ₹2 each), co-production.

PART 3 — MOVEMENTS, SCHOOLS AND STYLES

About this Part. A movement is a group of filmmakers in a time and place who share ideas about what cinema should be. Movements are how cinema argues with itself. Listed roughly in order of time.

MOV-08 Film movements of the world

Before you start — MOV-08. Read this with Part 1 (where the movements happened) and Part 8 (the theories behind them). **See also:** MOV-18 Film theory.

☐ **MOV-08.1 Early cinema "cinema of attractions" (1895–1906)**: films that showed rather than told: tricks, trains, dances (term by historian Tom Gunning).

☐ **MOV-08.2 Swedish silent golden age (1917–1924)**: Victor Sjöström, Mauritz Stiller; nature as emotion.

☐ **MOV-08.3 German Expressionism (1919–1930s)**: painted shadows and twisted sets showing inner fear; *Caligari*, *Nosferatu*, *Metropolis*; shaped horror and noir.

☐ **MOV-08.4 Soviet Montage (1924–1930)**: meaning made by collision of shots; Eisenstein, Vertov, Pudovkin, Kuleshov.

☐ **MOV-08.5 French Impressionism and Surrealism (1918–1930)**: Abel Gance, Germaine Dulac, Luis Buñuel and Salvador Dalí.

☐ **MOV-08.6 Classical Hollywood style (1917–1960)**: invisible editing, continuity, star and genre; the "standard" others reacted against.

☐ **MOV-08.7 Poetic Realism (France, 1930s)**: doomed lovers in foggy ports; Marcel Carné, Jean Renoir, Jean Vigo.

☐ **MOV-08.8 Italian Neorealism (1943–1952)**: real streets, non-actors, poverty after war; Rossellini, De Sica, Visconti; inspired Ray, Bimal Roy and the IPTA films.

☐ **MOV-08.9 IPTA and the Indian socialist realist films (1940s–1950s)**: Indian People's Theatre Association artists in cinema; *Dharti Ke Lal* (1946), *Neecha Nagar*, K. A. Abbas, Balraj Sahni.

☐ **MOV-08.10 Japanese golden age (1950s)**: Kurosawa, Ozu, Mizoguchi.

☐ **MOV-08.11 Free Cinema and British New Wave (1956–1963)**: working-class "kitchen sink" realism; Lindsay Anderson, Tony Richardson.

☐ **MOV-08.12 French New Wave / Nouvelle Vague (1958–1968)**: critics of *Cahiers du cinéma* turned directors; jump cuts, location shooting, the director as author; Truffaut, Godard, Rohmer, Rivette, Chabrol, Agnès Varda (Left Bank group).

☐ **MOV-08.13 Indian Parallel Cinema / New Indian Cinema (1952–1990s)**: realist, socially engaged, often state-funded; Ray, Ghatak, Sen, then Benegal, Nihalani, Adoor, Aravindan, Mani Kaul, Kumar Shahani, Girish Kasaravalli. Its "middle cinema" cousins: Hrishikesh Mukherjee, Basu Chatterjee, Gulzar.

☐ **MOV-08.14 Czechoslovak New Wave (1962–1968)**: absurd humour against censorship; Forman, Chytilová, Menzel.

☐ **MOV-08.15 Cinema Novo (Brazil, 1960s)**: "aesthetics of hunger"; Glauber Rocha, Nelson Pereira dos Santos.

☐ **MOV-08.16 Third Cinema (Latin America, 1969)**: political, anti-colonial cinema (manifesto by Solanas and Getino, Argentina).

☐ **MOV-08.17 New Hollywood (1967–1980)**: young directors, darker stories; *Bonnie and Clyde*, *Taxi Driver*.

☐ **MOV-08.18 New German Cinema (1962–1982)**: the Oberhausen Manifesto: "Papa's cinema is dead".

☐ **MOV-08.19 Iranian New Wave (1969–)**: poetic realism, children and landscapes; Mehrjui, Kiarostami, Makhmalbaf, Panahi.

☐ **MOV-08.20 Australian New Wave (1970s)** and **Taiwan New Cinema (1982–)**.

☐ **MOV-08.21 China's Fifth Generation (1984–)**: *Yellow Earth*, *Red Sorghum*.

☐ **MOV-08.22 Hong Kong New Wave (1979–)** and **heroic bloodshed**.

☐ **MOV-08.23 Cinéma du look (France, 1980s)**: stylish visuals; Luc Besson, Jean-Jacques Beineix.

☐ **MOV-08.24 New Queer Cinema (1990s)**: Todd Haynes, Gregg Araki.

☐ **MOV-08.25 Dogme 95 (Denmark, 1995)**: ten rules: handheld camera, real locations, no added music.

☐ **MOV-08.26 Korean New Wave (late 1990s–)**: genre-bending, bold violence and class satire.

☐ **MOV-08.27 Romanian New Wave (2001–)**: long takes, bureaucratic absurdity.

☐ **MOV-08.28 Mumblecore (USA, 2000s)**: micro-budget, naturalistic talk.

☐ **MOV-08.29 Greek Weird Wave (2009–)**: absurd, cold, disturbing; Yorgos Lanthimos.

☐ **MOV-08.30 Malayalam New Generation (2011–)** and the **new Hindi indie wave**: realism, regional texture, strong writing.

☐ **MOV-08.31 Pan-Indian cinema (2015–)**: big-budget films released in several languages at once.

☐ **MOV-08.32 Slow cinema** and **elevated horror** (contemporary tendencies).

PART 4 — THE HISTORY OF CINEMA: A TIMELINE

About this Part. The full story in order, with world and Indian events side by side. Every row can become a page on the website.

MOV-09 Timeline of world and Indian cinema

Before you start — MOV-09. Read the Introduction twig (Part 0) first for the story; use this timeline for the facts. **See also:** TEC (camera and sound technology), SNT-02 history of technology.

☐ MOV-09.1 Before cinema (prehistory to 1894)

☐ **Prehistory**: cave paintings with multiple legs suggesting movement; storytelling by firelight.
☐ **c. 200 BCE–200 CE**: Bharata's Natyashastra; Greek theatre; shadow puppetry spreads in Asia.
☐ **c. 1000 CE**: Ibn al-Haytham explains the camera obscura (Book of Optics).
☐ **1659**: magic lantern (Christiaan Huygens).
☐ **1820s–1830s**: thaumatrope, phenakistiscope (Joseph Plateau, 1832), zoetrope (1834).
☐ **1826–1839**: photography: Niépce's first photograph, Daguerre's daguerreotype (1839).
☐ **1878**: Muybridge's *Horse in Motion*.
☐ **1882**: Étienne-Jules Marey's chronophotographic gun.
☐ **1888**: Le Prince's *Roundhay Garden Scene*; Eastman's Kodak camera.
☐ **1889**: celluloid roll film (Eastman).
☐ **1891–1894**: Edison and Dickson's Kinetograph and Kinetoscope; first Kinetoscope parlour, New York (1894).

☐ MOV-09.2 The birth of cinema (1895–1910)

☐ **1895**: Skladanowsky brothers' Bioscop show in Berlin (November); Lumières' Cinématographe screening in Paris (28 December).
☐ **1896**: Lumière films in Bombay (7 July); cinema reaches every continent.
☐ **1899**: H. S. Bhatavdekar films a wrestling match (India).
☐ **1902**: Méliès' *A Trip to the Moon*; J. F. Madan begins film shows in Calcutta.
☐ **1903**: *The Great Train Robbery*.
☐ **1905**: first nickelodeon, Pittsburgh.
☐ **1906**: *The Story of the Kelly Gang* (Australia), early feature-length film.
☐ **1907**: Elphinstone Bioscope (Madan), early Indian film exhibition chain.
☐ **1908**: first animated cartoon (*Fantasmagorie*); Motion Picture Patents Company (USA).

☐ MOV-09.3 Silent features and the rise of industries (1910–1927)

☐ **1912–1913**: *Shree Pundalik* (1912); *Raja Harishchandra* (3 May 1913).
☐ **1914**: *Cabiria*; Chaplin's Tramp appears.
☐ **1915**: *The Birth of a Nation*.
☐ **1918**: Indian Cinematograph Act; *Keechaka Vadham* (South India).
☐ **1919–1920**: *The Cabinet of Dr. Caligari*; United Artists founded (Chaplin, Pickford, Fairbanks, Griffith).
☐ **1922**: *Nanook of the North*; *Nosferatu*.
☐ **1925**: *Battleship Potemkin*; *The Gold Rush*.
☐ **1927**: *Metropolis*; *Napoléon*; Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences founded; Indian Cinematograph Committee report (1927–28).

☐ MOV-09.4 The talkies and the studio era (1927–1945)

☐ **1927**: *The Jazz Singer*.
☐ **1928**: Mickey Mouse in *Steamboat Willie* (synchronised sound cartoon).
☐ **1929**: first Academy Awards (16 May).
☐ **1931**: *Alam Ara* (14 March); *Kalidas* (Tamil/Telugu).
☐ **1932**: first Venice Film Festival, the world's oldest.
☐ **1932–1934**: Indian studios: Prabhat (1929), New Theatres (1931), Bombay Talkies (1934).
☐ **1934**: Hollywood's Production Code enforced.
☐ **1935**: three-strip Technicolor feature *Becky Sharp*; *Devdas* (New Theatres).
☐ **1937**: *Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs*; *Kisan Kanya*, India's first indigenous colour film (Ardeshir Irani).
☐ **1939**: *Gone with the Wind*, *The Wizard of Oz*; Cannes planned, cancelled by war.
☐ **1940–1945**: wartime propaganda films; Gemini Studios rises (1940).

☐ MOV-09.5 The post-war golden ages (1945–1959)

☐ **1945–1948**: Italian Neorealism; *Bicycle Thieves*.
☐ **1946**: first Cannes festival; *Neecha Nagar* shares the Grand Prix.
☐ **1948**: Paramount decision ends the studio system in the USA.
☐ **1950–1951**: *Rashomon* wins at Venice; Berlin festival founded (1951); Central Board of Film Censors (India, 1951); Cinematograph Act 1952.
☐ **1952**: first International Film Festival of India (Bombay); Calcutta Film Society influence.
☐ **1953**: CinemaScope (*The Robe*); 3D boom.
☐ **1954**: first National Film Awards and first Filmfare Awards (India); *Seven Samurai*; *Godzilla*.
☐ **1955**: *Pather Panchali*; Children's Film Society India founded.
☐ **1957**: *Mother India*; *Pyaasa*; *The Seventh Seal*.
☐ **1959**: French New Wave (*The 400 Blows*, *Breathless* 1960).

☐ MOV-09.6 New waves and colour (1960–1975)

☐ **1960**: *Mughal-e-Azam*; *Psycho*; *La Dolce Vita*; Film Institute of India, Pune (FTII).
☐ **1962**: first James Bond film, *Dr. No*.
☐ **1964**: National Film Archive of India founded (Pune).
☐ **1968**: MPAA ratings replace the Hays Code; *2001: A Space Odyssey*.
☐ **1969**: Film Finance Corporation backs *Bhuvan Shome* and *Uski Roti*; Dadasaheb Phalke Award begins (Devika Rani).
☐ **1972**: *The Godfather*.
☐ **1973**: *Zanjeer*; *Enter the Dragon*.
☐ **1975**: *Sholay*, *Deewaar*, *Jai Santoshi Maa*; *Jaws*; NFDC formed (1975; the FFC merged into it in 1980).

☐ MOV-09.7 Blockbusters and video (1975–1995)

☐ **1977**: *Star Wars*; Industrial Light & Magic.
☐ **1980s**: VHS and the video boom; Doordarshan colour TV in India (1982 Asian Games).
☐ **1982**: *Gandhi* (Richard Attenborough), eight Oscars; Bhanu Athaiya becomes the first Indian Oscar winner (1983).
☐ **1984**: "Betamax case" ruling (USA); *My Dear Kuttichathan*, India's first 3D film.
☐ **1988**: *Salaam Bombay!* wins the Caméra d'Or.
☐ **1992**: Satyajit Ray's Honorary Oscar; *Living in Bondage* starts Nollywood; *Roja*.
☐ **1993**: *Jurassic Park*, CGI creatures.
☐ **1995**: *Toy Story*, first fully CGI feature; *DDLJ*; cinema's centenary.

☐ MOV-09.8 The digital turn (1995–2010)

☐ **1997**: PVR Anupam, India's first multiplex; *Titanic*.

☐ **1998**: Indian government grants film "industry" status (formalised 2000–2001), opening bank finance.

☐ **1999**: *The Matrix*; *The Blair Witch Project*; first digital cinema projections.

☐ **2001**: *Lagaan* Oscar-nominated; *The Lord of the Rings* begins; *Spirited Away*.

☐ **2002**: *Star Wars: Episode II* shot fully on digital video.

☐ **2007**: Netflix starts streaming.

☐ **2009**: *Avatar*'s 3D; *Slumdog Millionaire* wins eight Oscars, including two for A. R. Rahman and one each for Resul Pookutty and Gulzar (for lyrics, shared with Rahman).

☐ MOV-09.9 Streaming, franchises and the global screen (2010–present)

☐ **2012**: most US cinemas have converted to digital projection; 35 mm prints are phased out.

☐ **2015–2017**: *Baahubali* films; Chinese box office booms.

☐ **2016**: Netflix and Amazon Prime Video launch in India (Hotstar began in 2015); Netflix reaches 190 countries.

☐ **2019**: *Avengers: Endgame*; *Parasite* (Palme d'Or, then Oscars in 2020).

☐ **2020–2021**: COVID-19 closes cinemas; direct-to-streaming releases.

☐ **2022**: *RRR*; Films Division and other units merged into NFDC; *Jeanne Dielman* tops Sight and Sound.

☐ **2023**: "Naatu Naatu" and *The Elephant Whisperers* win Oscars; WGA and SAG-AFTRA strikes over pay and AI; Cinematograph (Amendment) Act 2023 against piracy.

☐ **2024**: *All We Imagine as Light* wins Cannes Grand Prix; CBFC's new age-based U/A categories.

☐ **2025**: *Ne Zha 2* becomes the highest-grossing animated film; Jafar Panahi wins the Palme d'Or.

☐ **2026**: *One Battle After Another* wins Best Picture (March); Cristian Mungiu's *Fjord* wins the Palme d'Or (May); *Woman Unknown* wins the Golden Lion (September); *Avengers: Endgame* re-takes the all-time box-office record after a re-release (October). (As checked on 3 November 2026.)

☐ **The present scenario**: streaming and theatres side by side; AI tools on set; regional-language cinema rising; Asia as the growth centre of world box office.

PART 5 — AWARDS, FESTIVALS AND RECORDS

About this Part. For each award: what it is, who gives it, how and when it began, its first winner, landmark winners, records and the latest winner, with the date the fact was checked. International awards and festivals come first, then national awards country by country, with India in full. **As checked on 3 November 2026.** Sources: the official site of each award (Part 13).

MOV-10 International film awards

Before you start — MOV-10. "International" here means awards watched by the whole world, even if one country's academy gives them (like the Oscars). **See also:** MOV-11 Festivals, MOV-13 Records, MOV-14 People.

☐ MOV-10.1 Academy Awards (the Oscars), USA

Given every year by the Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences (AMPAS, founded 1927) to honour films released in the previous year; voted by about 10,000 film professionals. The gold statuette was designed by Cedric Gibbons and sculpted by George Stanley. **Tags:** #award #usa #oscars

- ☐ **How it began**: the first ceremony was a 15-minute dinner at the Hollywood Roosevelt Hotel on **16 May 1929**.
- ☐ **First winners**: *Wings* (Outstanding Picture) and *Sunrise* (Unique and Artistic Production); Emil Jannings (Actor) and Janet Gaynor (Actress).
- ☐ **Main categories**: Picture, Director, Actor, Actress, Supporting roles, Original and Adapted Screenplay, International Feature Film (earlier "Foreign Language Film", from 1956 as a competitive category), Animated Feature (from 2001), Documentary, Cinematography, Editing, Score, Song, Sound, Production Design, Costume, Makeup and Hairstyling, Visual Effects, Short films, Casting (first given at the 98th ceremony, 2026), Honorary awards.
- ☐ **Landmark winners**: Hattie McDaniel, first Black winner (1940); *All About Eve* (14 nominations); Sidney Poitier, first Black Best Actor (1964); *Parasite* (2020), first non-English Best Picture; Kathryn Bigelow, first woman Best Director (2010); Michelle Yeoh, first Asian Best Actress (2023).
- ☐ **Records**: most wins for a film: 11 (*Ben-Hur*, *Titanic*, *The Lord of the Rings: The Return of the King*); most wins for a person: Walt Disney (22 competitive); most acting wins: Katharine Hepburn (4); most nominations for an actor: Meryl Streep (21).
- ☐ **India at the Oscars**: Bhanu Athaiya (Costume Design, *Gandhi*, 1983), the first Indian winner; Satyajit Ray (Honorary Award, 1992); A. R. Rahman (two), Resul Pookutty and Gulzar for *Slumdog Millionaire* (2009); M. M. Keeravani and Chandrabose for "Naatu Naatu" (*RRR*) and Kartiki Gonsalves and Guneet Monga for *The Elephant Whisperers* (2023); Indian engineers have also won Scientific and Technical Awards. India's nominations for International Feature: *Mother India* (1958), *Salaam Bombay!* (1989), *Lagaan* (2002).
- ☐ **Latest: 98th Academy Awards (15 March 2026)**: Best Picture *One Battle After Another*; Director Paul Thomas Anderson; Actor Michael B. Jordan (*Sinners*); Actress Jessie Buckley (*Hamnet*); Supporting Actor Sean Penn; Supporting Actress Amy Madigan (*Weapons*); International Feature *Sentimental Value* (Norway); Animated Feature *KPop Demon Hunters*.

☐ MOV-10.2 BAFTA Film Awards, United Kingdom

The British Academy of Film and Television Arts awards (the academy began in 1947; first film awards in **1949**). The mask trophy was designed by Mitzi Cunliffe. First Best Film: *The Best Years of Our Lives*. Seen as a guide to the Oscars. **Latest (22 February 2026)**: Best Film *One Battle After Another*, which won six BAFTAs. **Tags:** #award #uk

☐ MOV-10.3 Golden Globe Awards, USA

Begun in **1944** by the Hollywood Foreign Press Association (dissolved in 2023; the Globes are now run by a private company with an international voting body). Separate Drama and Musical/Comedy categories; also television. First Best Picture: *The Song of Bernadette*. **Latest**: see goldenglobes.com (not verified for this edition). **Tags:** #award #usa

☐ MOV-10.4 European Film Awards

Given by the European Film Academy since **1988** (first Best Film: Krzysztof Kieślowski's *A Short Film About Killing*). Celebrates European cinema across borders.

☐ MOV-10.5 Asian Film Awards and Asia Pacific Screen Awards

Asian Film Awards (Hong Kong, since **2007**) and the Asia Pacific Screen Awards (Australia, since **2007**) honour films across Asia and the Pacific, including India.

☐ MOV-10.6 Other international honours

☐ **FIPRESCI Prize**: from the International Federation of Film Critics (founded 1925), given at festivals worldwide.

☐ **Annie Awards** (since 1972): the top awards for animation.

☐ **Platino Awards** (since 2014): Ibero-American (Spanish- and Portuguese-language) cinema.

☐ **Africa Movie Academy Awards (AMAA)** (since 2005) and **Africa Magic Viewers' Choice Awards (AMVCA)** (since 2013).

☐ **Lux Audience Award** of the European Parliament.

☐ **Saturn Awards** (science fiction, fantasy, horror, since 1972) and the **Golden Raspberry ("Razzies")** for the worst films (since 1981).

☐ **Emmy Awards**: for television, not film (included here only to avoid confusion).

MOV-11 Film festivals of the world and their top prizes

Before you start — MOV-11. Festivals are where art cinema is discovered and sold. The **FIAPF** (International Federation of Film Producers Associations) accredits competitive festivals; the most prestigious are called the "Big Three": Cannes, Venice and Berlin.

☐ MOV-11.1 Cannes Film Festival (Festival de Cannes), France

Held every May on the French Riviera. Planned for 1939 as a free alternative to a Venice festival then influenced by fascist Italy, but cancelled by the Second World War; first held in **1946**. **Tags:** #festival #france #cannes

☐ **Top prize**: the **Palme d'Or** (from 1955; earlier the Grand Prix). First Palme d'Or: *Marty* (Delbert Mann, 1955).

☐ **Other prizes**: Grand Prix, Jury Prize, Best Director, Best Actor, Best Actress, Best Screenplay, Caméra d'Or (best first film), Un Certain Regard, Short Film Palme d'Or; parallel sections Directors' Fortnight and Critics' Week.

☐ **Landmarks**: *Neecha Nagar* shared the first Grand Prix (1946); Jane Campion became the first woman to win (*The Piano*, 1993, shared); *Parasite* (2019) was the first Korean winner. Two-time winners include Francis Ford Coppola, Shohei Imamura, Emir Kusturica, Bille August, the Dardenne brothers, Ken Loach, Michael Haneke, Ruben Östlund and Cristian Mungiu.

☐ **India at Cannes**: *Neecha Nagar* (1946), *Do Bigha Zamin* (Prix International, 1954), *Pather Panchali* (Best Human Document, 1956), *Kharij* (Jury Prize, 1983), *Salaam Bombay!* (Caméra d'Or, 1988), *Marana Simhasanam* (Caméra d'Or, 1999), *All We Imagine as Light* (Grand Prix, 2024), Anasuya Sengupta (Best Actress, Un Certain Regard, 2024, *The Shameless*).

☐ **Latest: 79th festival (May 2026)**: Palme d'Or *Fjord* (Cristian Mungiu, his second); Grand Prix *Minotaur* (Andrey Zvyagintsev); Best Director shared by Javier Calvo and Javier Ambrossi (*La Bola Negra*) and Paweł Pawlikowski (*Fatherland*).

☐ MOV-11.2 Venice International Film Festival (Mostra), Italy

The **oldest film festival in the world**, first held in **1932** as part of the Venice Biennale, every late August–September on the Lido. **Tags:** #festival #italy #venice

☐ **Top prize**: the **Golden Lion** (Leone d'Oro), named in 1949; first winner under that name: *Manon* (Henri-Georges Clouzot, 1949).

☐ **Other prizes**: Silver Lion (Grand Jury Prize and Best Director), Volpi Cups for acting, Orizzonti section, Golden Lion for Lifetime Achievement.

☐ **Landmarks**: *Rashomon* (1951) introduced Japanese cinema to the West; Satyajit Ray's *Aparajito* (1957); Mira Nair's *Monsoon Wedding* (2001); *Joker* (2019) and *Nomadland* (2020).

☐ **Latest: 83rd festival (September 2026)**: Golden Lion *Woman Unknown* (*Kvinde Ukendt*, May el-Toukhy, Denmark); Silver Lion Grand Jury Prize *Possible Love* (Lee Chang-dong); Volpi Cups to Mathilde Arcel and John Malkovich. (2025: *Father Mother Sister Brother*, Jim Jarmusch.)

☐ MOV-11.3 Berlin International Film Festival (Berlinale), Germany

Founded in **1951** in West Berlin, in February; known for political and diverse cinema and the biggest public audience of the Big Three. **Tags:** #festival #germany #berlin

☐ **Top prize**: the **Golden Bear**; Silver Bears for direction, performance (gender-neutral since 2021), screenplay and more; the Teddy Award for LGBTQ+ films (1987).

☐ **India at Berlin**: Satyajit Ray won Silver Bears for Best Director (*Mahanagar*, 1964; *Charulata*, 1965) and the Golden Bear for *Ashani Sanket* (1973); Mrinal Sen's *Akaler Sandhane* (Silver Bear, 1981).

☐ **Latest: 76th Berlinale (February 2026)**: Golden Bear *Yellow Letters* (İlker Çatak). (2025: *Dreams (Sex Love)*, Dag Johan Haugerud; 2024: *Dahomey*, Mati Diop.)

☐ MOV-11.4 Other major competitive festivals (FIAPF-accredited and leading)

☐ **San Sebastián** (Spain, 1953): Golden Shell.

☐ **Locarno** (Switzerland, 1946): Golden Leopard; open-air Piazza Grande.

☐ **Karlovy Vary** (Czech Republic, 1946): Crystal Globe.

☐ **Tokyo International** (Japan, 1985): Tokyo Grand Prix.

☐ **Shanghai International** (China, 1993): Golden Goblet.

☐ **Cairo International** (Egypt, 1976): Golden Pyramid; the Arab world's oldest competitive festival accredited by FIAPF.

☐ **Mar del Plata** (Argentina, 1954): Latin America's only FIAPF competitive festival.

☐ **Tallinn Black Nights** (Estonia, 1997) and **Warsaw** (Poland, 1985).

☐ **International Film Festival of India (IFFI), Goa** (1952): Golden Peacock; FIAPF-accredited competitive festival; Satyajit Ray Lifetime Achievement Award.

☐ MOV-11.5 Leading non-competitive and specialist festivals

☐ **Toronto International Film Festival (TIFF)** (Canada, 1976): the People's Choice Award, a famous Oscar predictor.

☐ **Sundance** (USA, 1978; Sundance name 1991): American independent cinema.

☐ **Telluride** (1974) and **New York Film Festival** (1963).

☐ **Busan International** (South Korea, 1996): Asia's most important festival.

☐ **International Film Festival Rotterdam** (1972): Tiger Awards for new talent.

☐ **Annecy** (France, 1960): animation. **Clermont-Ferrand** (France): short films. **IDFA** Amsterdam (1988) and **Hot Docs** Toronto: documentary.

☐ **FESPACO**, Ouagadougou (Burkina Faso, 1969): Golden Stallion of Yennenga, Africa's top prize. **Carthage Film Days** (Tunisia, 1966).

☐ **Red Sea International** (Saudi Arabia, 2021); **Sydney** (1954); **Melbourne** (1952).

☐ **Indian festivals**: Jio MAMI Mumbai Film Festival (1997), International Film Festival of Kerala (1996, the Suvarna Chakoram), Kolkata International (1995), Chennai, Bengaluru, Dharamshala, Pune International, Habitat, Mumbai International Film Festival for documentaries (MIFF, 1990).

MOV-12 National film awards, country by country

Before you start — MOV-12. Each country honours its own cinema. India comes first and in full; then every region. **See also:** MOV-01 to MOV-05 (each industry's register lists its award winners).

☐ MOV-12.1 India

☐ **National Film Awards** (since **1954**): India's highest film honours, given by the President of India; managed today by the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting through NFDC (earlier the Directorate of Film Festivals). Golden Lotus (Swarna Kamal) and Silver Lotus (Rajat Kamal) medals. First Best Feature Film: *Shyamchi Aai* (Marathi). Records: Shabana Azmi, five Best Actress awards; Amitabh Bachchan, four Best Actor awards. **Latest verified: 71st National Film Awards** (announced 1 August 2025, presented 23 September 2025, for films of 2023): Best Feature Film *12th Fail*; Best Actor Shah Rukh Khan (*Jawan*) and Vikrant Massey (*12th Fail*); Best Actress Rani Mukerji (*Mrs Chatterjee vs Norway*).

☐ **Dadasaheb Phalke Award** (since **1969**): India's highest honour for lifetime contribution to cinema, given with the National Film Awards. First awardee: Devika Rani. Recent: Mithun Chakraborty (2022 award), Mohanlal (2023 award, presented 2025).

☐ **Filmfare Awards** (since **21 March 1954**): the oldest major popular film awards, by *Filmfare* magazine (Times Group); voted by audience and jury. First Best Film *Do Bigha Zamin*; first Best Actor Dilip Kumar (*Daag*); first Best Actress Meena Kumari (*Baiju Bawra*). Records: Dilip Kumar and Shah Rukh Khan, eight Best Actor awards each. **Latest: 70th Filmfare Awards (11 October 2025, Ahmedabad)**: Best Film *Laapataa Ladies* (13 awards, equalling *Gully Boy*'s record); Best Actor Abhishek Bachchan and Kartik Aaryan; Best Actress Alia Bhatt (*Jigra*). Also **Filmfare Awards South**, **Marathi**, **Bangla**, **Punjabi** and **OTT** editions.

☐ **Bengal Film Journalists' Association Awards** (since **1937**): the oldest film awards association in India.

☐ **IIFA Awards** (International Indian Film Academy, since **2000**, held abroad; first Best Film *Hum Dil De Chuke Sanam*), plus IIFA Utsavam for South Indian films.

☐ **Screen Awards** (1995), **Zee Cine Awards** (1998), **SIIMA** (South Indian International Movie Awards, 2012).

☐ **State film awards**: Maharashtra State (1963), Kerala State (1969), Tamil Nadu State (1967), Karnataka State (1967), Nandi Awards (Andhra Pradesh, 1964), Telangana Gaddar Film Awards (2025), West Bengal, Odisha, Gujarat, Punjab, Assam and others.

☐ **Civilian honours to film artists**: Bharat Ratna (Satyajit Ray, 1992; Lata Mangeshkar, 2001; M. G. Ramachandran, 1988, mainly as a political leader), Padma awards.

☐ MOV-12.2 The Americas

☐ **USA**: Academy Awards (MOV-10.1), Golden Globes, Screen Actors Guild Awards (1995; renamed the Actor Awards), Directors Guild of America Awards (1949), Producers Guild Awards, Independent Spirit Awards (1986), Critics Choice Awards, the National Film Registry (Library of Congress, 1989; an honour of preservation).

☐ **Canada**: Canadian Screen Awards (2013; successor of the Genie Awards, 1980, and Canadian Film Awards, 1949); Québec's Prix Iris.

☐ **Mexico**: Ariel Awards (1947), by the Mexican Academy of Film.

☐ **Brazil**: Grande Prêmio do Cinema Brasileiro (2000); Gramado Festival's Kikito (1973).

☐ **Argentina**: Silver Condor (critics, 1943) and Premios Sur (2006).

☐ **Colombia, Chile (Premios Caleuche), Cuba (Coral prizes of the Havana Festival), Peru, Venezuela.**

☐ MOV-12.3 Europe

☐ **France**: César Awards (1976; first Best Film *Le Vieux Fusil*), Louis Delluc Prize (1937), Lumière Awards (foreign press).

☐ **Italy**: David di Donatello (1956), Nastro d'Argento (1946, from film journalists, among Europe's oldest).

☐ **Spain**: Goya Awards (1987; first Best Film *El viaje a ninguna parte*).

☐ **Germany**: German Film Award, the Lola (1951). **Austria**: Austrian Film Award.

☐ **United Kingdom**: BAFTA (MOV-10.2), British Independent Film Awards (1998).

☐ **Russia**: Nika Award (1988), Golden Eagle (2002).

☐ **Sweden**: Guldbagge (1964). **Denmark**: Bodil (1948, one of Europe's oldest) and Robert (1984). **Norway**: Amanda (1985). **Finland**: Jussi (1944). **Iceland**: Edda.

☐ **Poland**: Polish Film Awards, the Eagles (1999). **Czech Republic**: Czech Lion (1993). **Hungary, Romania (Gopo Awards), Greece (Hellenic Film Academy), Turkey (Golden Orange, Antalya, 1964), Portugal (Sophia Awards), Netherlands (Golden Calf), Belgium (Magritte), Ireland (IFTA).**

☐ MOV-12.4 Asia and the Middle East

☐ **Japan**: Japan Academy Film Prize (1978), Kinema Junpo Best Ten (since 1924, the oldest film ranking), Mainichi Film Awards (1946), Blue Ribbon Awards (1950).

☐ **China**: Golden Rooster Awards (1981), Hundred Flowers Awards (1962, audience-voted). **Hong Kong**: Hong Kong Film Awards (1982). **Taiwan**: Golden Horse Awards (1962), open to all Chinese-language films.

☐ **South Korea**: Grand Bell Awards (1962), Blue Dragon Film Awards (1963), Baeksang Arts Awards (1965).

☐ **Pakistan**: Nigar Awards (1957), Lux Style Awards (2002). **Bangladesh**: National Film Awards (1975). **Sri Lanka**: Sarasaviya Awards (1964). **Nepal**: National Film Awards.

☐ **Iran**: Crystal Simorgh (Fajr Film Festival, 1982). **Israel**: Ophir Awards. **Egypt**: National Film Festival awards; **Arab world**: Arab Critics' Awards.

☐ **Philippines**: FAMAS (1952), Gawad Urian (1977), Metro Manila Film Festival awards. **Indonesia**: Citra Awards (1955). **Thailand**: Suphannahong (1992). **Vietnam**: Golden Kite. **Malaysia**: Malaysia Film Festival awards.

☐ MOV-12.5 Africa and Oceania

☐ **Nigeria**: AMVCA (2013) and AMAA (pan-African, 2005). **South Africa**: South African Film and Television Awards (2006). **Ghana**: Ghana Movie Awards. **Kenya**: Kalasha Awards. **Pan-Africa**: FESPACO's Golden Stallion (MOV-11.5).

☐ **Australia**: AACTA Awards (since 1958 as the AFI Awards). **New Zealand**: New Zealand Film Awards.

MOV-13 Records, firsts and fun facts

☐ **MOV-13.1 Highest-grossing film worldwide**: *Avengers: Endgame* (about US$2.93 billion, as checked 5 Oct 2026, after its 2026 re-release); adjusted for inflation, *Gone with the Wind*.

☐ **MOV-13.2 Highest-grossing Indian film**: *Dangal* (about ₹2,000 crore worldwide).

☐ **MOV-13.3 Longest-running film in a single cinema (India)**: *Dilwale Dulhania Le Jayenge* at Maratha Mandir, Mumbai (from 1995; shown for decades).

☐ **MOV-13.4 Largest film producer by number**: India (CBFC certification data), followed by Nigeria and the USA or China depending on the year (UNESCO Institute for Statistics).

☐ **MOV-13.5 Most screen credits for a living actor**: Brahmanandam (Telugu comedian), recognised by Guinness World Records.

☐ **MOV-13.6 Most studio recordings of songs**: Asha Bhosle, recognised by Guinness World Records (2011).

☐ **MOV-13.7 Longest film franchise**: *Godzilla* (Japan, from 1954), by continuous production.

☐ **MOV-13.8 Firsts in India**: first feature (1913), talkie (1931), indigenous colour film (*Kisan Kanya*, 1937), 3D film (*My Dear Kuttichathan*, 1984), CinemaScope film (*Kaagaz Ke Phool*, 1959), Oscar (1983).

☐ **MOV-13.9 Firsts for women**: Alice Guy-Blaché, one of the first film directors (*The Fairy of the Cabbages*, 1896); Fatma Begum, India's first woman director (*Bulbul-e-Paristan*, 1926); Devika Rani, first Dadasaheb Phalke awardee.

☐ **MOV-13.10 Greatest films polls**: the BFI *Sight and Sound* poll every ten years since 1952 (2022 critics' winner: *Jeanne Dielman, 23 quai du Commerce, 1080 Bruxelles*; directors' winner: *2001: A Space Odyssey*); in India, CNN-IBN's 2013 poll (*Mayabazar*).

PART 6 — THE PEOPLE OF CINEMA

About this Part. The pioneers and masters, by role and by country. Each name will become a profile page (birth, works, awards, why they matter). This is a selection of the most influential; every industry section in Part 1 adds its own stars.

MOV-14 Pioneers, masters and stars

Before you start — MOV-14. Search a name, then follow its tags to the films, awards and industries. **See also:** MOV-01 to MOV-05, MOV-10 to MOV-12.

☐ MOV-14.1 Inventors and pioneers

Eadweard Muybridge, Étienne-Jules Marey, Louis Le Prince, Thomas Edison and W. K. L. Dickson, Auguste and Louis Lumière, Georges Méliès, Alice Guy-Blaché, Edwin S. Porter, D. W. Griffith, Max and Emil Skladanowsky, Hiralal Sen (early Bengali filmmaker), H. S. Bhatavdekar, J. F. Madan, Dadasaheb Phalke, R. Nataraja Mudaliar, J. C. Daniel, Ardeshir Irani.

☐ MOV-14.2 Great directors of India

- ☐ **Hindi**: Raj Kapoor, Guru Dutt, Bimal Roy, Mehboob Khan, K. Asif, V. Shantaram, Hrishikesh Mukherjee, Basu Chatterjee, Gulzar, Yash Chopra, Ramesh Sippy, Manmohan Desai, Shyam Benegal, Govind Nihalani, Mani Kaul, Kumar Shahani, Sai Paranjpye, Sanjay Leela Bhansali, Rajkumar Hirani, Anurag Kashyap, Vishal Bhardwaj, Zoya Akhtar, Dibakar Banerjee.
- ☐ **Bengali**: Satyajit Ray, Ritwik Ghatak, Mrinal Sen, Tapan Sinha, Aparna Sen, Rituparno Ghosh, Buddhadeb Dasgupta, Goutam Ghose.
- ☐ **Tamil**: K. Balachander, Bharathiraja, Mahendran, Balu Mahendra, Mani Ratnam, S. Shankar, Bala, Vetrimaaran, Pa. Ranjith, Lokesh Kanagaraj.
- ☐ **Telugu**: K. V. Reddy, B. N. Reddy, K. Viswanath, Bapu, Dasari Narayana Rao, S. S. Rajamouli, Sukumar, Sekhar Kammula, Nag Ashwin.
- ☐ **Malayalam**: Ramu Kariat, Adoor Gopalakrishnan, G. Aravindan, K. G. George, P. Padmarajan, Bharathan, Shaji N. Karun, Priyadarshan, Lijo Jose Pellissery, Dileesh Pothan.
- ☐ **Kannada and others**: Puttanna Kanagal, Girish Karnad, Girish Kasaravalli, Rishab Shetty; Marathi: Jabbar Patel, Nagraj Manjule, Chaitanya Tamhane; Assamese: Jahnu Barua, Rima Das; Manipuri: Aribam Syam Sharma; Odia: Nirad Mohapatra.

☐ MOV-14.3 Great directors of the world

- ☐ **USA**: D. W. Griffith, Charlie Chaplin, Buster Keaton, John Ford, Howard Hawks, Frank Capra, Orson Welles, Billy Wilder, Alfred Hitchcock (also UK), Stanley Kubrick, Francis Ford Coppola, Martin Scorsese, Steven Spielberg, Spike Lee, Quentin Tarantino, Christopher Nolan, Kathryn Bigelow, Greta Gerwig, Paul Thomas Anderson, Ryan Coogler.
- ☐ **Europe**: Sergei Eisenstein, Fritz Lang, F. W. Murnau, Jean Renoir, Carl Theodor Dreyer, Ingmar Bergman, Federico Fellini, Michelangelo Antonioni, Luchino Visconti, Roberto Rossellini, Vittorio De Sica, François Truffaut, Jean-Luc Godard, Agnès Varda, Andrei Tarkovsky, Luis Buñuel, Pedro Almodóvar, Krzysztof Kieślowski, Werner Herzog, Rainer Werner Fassbinder, Michael Haneke, Ken Loach, Chantal Akerman.
- ☐ **Asia**: Akira Kurosawa, Yasujirō Ozu, Kenji Mizoguchi, Hayao Miyazaki, Hirokazu Kore-eda, Zhang Yimou, Wong Kar-wai, Hou Hsiao-hsien, Edward Yang, Ang Lee, Bong Joon-ho, Park Chan-wook, Abbas Kiarostami, Asghar Farhadi, Jafar Panahi, Nuri Bilge Ceylan, Apichatpong Weerasethakul, Lino Brocka.
- ☐ **Africa and Latin America**: Ousmane Sembène, Youssef Chahine, Souleymane Cissé, Djibril Diop Mambéty, Abderrahmane Sissako, Glauber Rocha, Alfonso Cuarón, Guillermo del Toro, Alejandro G. Iñárritu, Lucrecia Martel.

☐ MOV-14.4 Actors and stars

- ☐ **India**: Prithviraj Kapoor, Ashok Kumar, Dilip Kumar, Raj Kapoor, Dev Anand, Nargis, Madhubala, Meena Kumari, Waheeda Rehman, Nutan, Rajesh Khanna, Amitabh Bachchan, Hema Malini, Rekha, Smita Patil, Shabana Azmi, Naseeruddin Shah,

Om Puri, Sridevi, Madhuri Dixit, Shah Rukh Khan, Aamir Khan, Salman Khan, Irrfan Khan, Nawazuddin Siddiqui, Deepika Padukone, Alia Bhatt; M. G. Ramachandran, Sivaji Ganesan, Gemini Ganesan, Savitri, Kamal Haasan, Rajinikanth, Vijay, Ajith Kumar, Suriya, Nayanthara; N. T. Rama Rao, Akkineni Nageswara Rao, Chiranjeevi, Mahesh Babu, Prabhas, Allu Arjun, Jr NTR, Ram Charan; Prem Nazir, Sathyan, Mammootty, Mohanlal, Fahadh Faasil, Shobana; Dr Rajkumar, Vishnuvardhan, Puneeth Rajkumar, Yash; Uttam Kumar, Suchitra Sen, Soumitra Chatterjee, Madhabi Mukherjee.

- ☐ **World**: Charlie Chaplin, Greta Garbo, Marlene Dietrich, Humphrey Bogart, Ingrid Bergman, Marilyn Monroe, Marlon Brando, Audrey Hepburn, Toshirō Mifune, Sophia Loren, Marcello Mastroianni, Alain Delon, Catherine Deneuve, Jack Nicholson, Robert De Niro, Al Pacino, Meryl Streep, Bruce Lee, Jackie Chan, Maggie Cheung, Gong Li, Song Kang-ho, Penélope Cruz, Isabelle Huppert, Denzel Washington, Leonardo DiCaprio, Cate Blanchett, Michelle Yeoh, Omar Sharif, Genevieve Nnaji.

☐ MOV-14.5 Writers, composers and singers

- ☐ **Screenwriters**: Salim–Javed, Gulzar, K. A. Abbas, Rahi Masoom Raza, M. T. Vasudevan Nair, Sreenivasan, Ben Hecht, Billy Wilder and I. A. L. Diamond, Charlie Kaufman, Aaron Sorkin, Phoebe Waller-Bridge.
- ☐ **Composers and music directors**: R. C. Boral, Naushad, S. D. Burman, Shankar–Jaikishan, Madan Mohan, R. D. Burman, Laxmikant–Pyarelal, Ilaiyaraaja, M. S. Viswanathan, A. R. Rahman, M. M. Keeravani; Max Steiner, Bernard Herrmann, Ennio Morricone, John Williams, Hans Zimmer, Joe Hisaishi, Ryuichi Sakamoto.
- ☐ **Playback singers**: K. L. Saigal (singer-actor), Lata Mangeshkar, Asha Bhosle, Mohammed Rafi, Kishore Kumar, Mukesh, Geeta Dutt, Manna Dey, S. P. Balasubrahmanyam, K. J. Yesudas, P. Susheela, S. Janaki, Kavita Krishnamurthy, Sonu Nigam, Shreya Ghoshal, Arijit Singh.
- ☐ **Lyricists**: Sahir Ludhianvi, Shailendra, Majrooh Sultanpuri, Shakeel Badayuni, Anand Bakshi, Gulzar, Javed Akhtar, Kannadasan, Vairamuthu, Sirivennela Seetharama Sastry, Vayalar Ramavarma, Chandrabose.

☐ MOV-14.6 Cinematographers, editors, designers and technicians

Subrata Mitra, V. K. Murthy, Santosh Sivan, P. C. Sreeram, Ravi K. Chandran; Gregg Toland, Sven Nykvist, Vittorio Storaro, Roger Deakins, Emmanuel Lubezki; editors Thelma Schoonmaker, Walter Murch, Sreekar Prasad; art directors Nitin Desai, Sabu Cyril; costume designer Bhanu Athaiya; sound designer Resul Pookutty; VFX pioneers Ray Harryhausen, Dennis Muren.

☐ MOV-14.7 Producers, studio founders and builders

Himanshu Rai, Devika Rani, B. N. Sircar (New Theatres), V. Shantaram (Prabhat, Rajkamal), S. S. Vasan (Gemini), A. V. Meiyappan (AVM), B. Nagi Reddy (Vijaya Vauhini), Ramoji Rao (Ramoji Film City), Yash Johar, Karan Johar, Ronnie Screwvala, Guneet Monga; Louis B. Mayer, the Warner brothers, Walt Disney, Irving Thalberg, Run Run Shaw, Kevin Feige.

PART 7 — THE CRAFT, TECHNOLOGY AND BUSINESS OF FILM

MOV-15 Who does what: the film crew

Before you start — MOV-15. A film credit can list thousands of people. Here is each role in one line. **See also:** MOV-16 Pipeline.

- ☐ **MOV-15.1 Producer**: finds the money, assembles the team and is responsible for the film from start to release.
- ☐ **MOV-15.2 Director**: the creative leader who decides how the story will be told on screen.
- ☐ **MOV-15.3 Screenwriter**: writes the story, scenes and dialogue (in India the story, screenplay and dialogue are often credited separately).
- ☐ **MOV-15.4 Cast**: lead, supporting, character actors, junior artists (extras), stunt performers, body doubles, voice and dubbing artists.
- ☐ **MOV-15.5 Cinematographer / Director of Photography (DOP)**: designs the light and camera; with camera operators, focus pullers and gaffers.
- ☐ **MOV-15.6 Production designer / art director**: creates the world: sets, locations, props.
- ☐ **MOV-15.7 Costume, makeup and hair**: how characters look.
- ☐ **MOV-15.8 Editor**: chooses and joins shots; often called the "final rewrite".
- ☐ **MOV-15.9 Sound team**: location sound recordist, sound designer, Foley artist (recreated everyday sounds), re-recording mixer.
- ☐ **MOV-15.10 Music director / composer, lyricist, playback singer, choreographer**.
- ☐ **MOV-15.11 VFX and animation artists**: compositing, CGI, motion capture, colourist (colour grading, DI).
- ☐ **MOV-15.12 Assistant directors, line producer, casting director, location manager, script supervisor (continuity)**.
- ☐ **MOV-15.13 Distributors, exhibitors, marketing and publicity teams**.

MOV-16 How a film is made, and the technology behind it

- ☐ **MOV-16.1 Development**: idea, rights, story, screenplay, pitching, financing.
- ☐ **MOV-16.2 Pre-production**: casting, storyboards, location scouting, schedule, budget, rehearsals.
- ☐ **MOV-16.3 Production (the shoot)**: shots, takes, coverage, call sheets; the shot sizes (extreme wide to extreme close-up), angles and camera moves (pan, tilt, dolly, crane, Steadicam, drone).
- ☐ **MOV-16.4 Post-production**: editing, dubbing (ADR), sound design, music, VFX, colour grading, subtitles, censorship certification.
- ☐ **MOV-16.5 Distribution and exhibition**: festivals, theatrical release, streaming, satellite, airlines, re-releases.
- ☐ **MOV-16.6 Film language**: mise-en-scène, montage, continuity editing, the 180-degree rule, match cut, jump cut, long take, deep focus, point-of-view shot, cross-cutting, the MacGuffin, the fourth wall.
- ☐ **MOV-16.7 Camera and film technology**: 35 mm and 16 mm film, 70 mm and IMAX, aspect ratios (1.37:1 to 2.39:1), digital cinema cameras (ARRI, RED, Sony), lenses, anamorphic.
- ☐ **MOV-16.8 Sound technology**: optical sound (1920s), magnetic, Dolby Stereo (1975), digital sound (Dolby Digital, DTS, 1990s), Dolby Atmos (2012).
- ☐ **MOV-16.9 Colour technology**: hand-painting and tinting, two-strip and three-strip Technicolor, Eastmancolor (1950), digital intermediate (2000).
- ☐ **MOV-16.10 Visual effects**: stop-trick (Méliès), matte painting, miniatures, rear projection, stop-motion, blue and green screen, CGI (*Jurassic Park*, 1993), motion capture (*The Lord of the Rings*), de-ageing, virtual production (LED volumes).
- ☐ **MOV-16.11 Animation technology**: cel, rotoscope, multiplane camera (Disney, 1937), CGI render farms.
- ☐ **MOV-16.12 Projection and exhibition**: single screens, multiplexes, digital projection (DCP), 3D, 4DX, laser projection, home theatre.

☐ **MOV-16.13 AI in filmmaking**: script tools, dubbing and lip-sync, de-ageing, generative video; rules, consent and credit debates.

MOV-17 The business, law and preservation of cinema

☐ **MOV-17.1 Box office explained**: gross, net, distributor share, budgets, recovery, hit/flop labels (link MOV-00.11).

☐ **MOV-17.2 Distribution territories in India**: Bombay, Delhi–UP, East Punjab, CP–Berar, CI, Rajasthan, Nizam, Mysore, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Bihar, Bengal, Assam, Orissa (the traditional "circuits").

☐ **MOV-17.3 Censorship and certification**: India's CBFC under the Cinematograph Act 1952 (amended 2023); USA's MPA ratings (1968), UK's BBFC (1912); famous censorship cases and banned films.

☐ **MOV-17.4 Copyright, remakes and piracy**: remake rights, dubbing rights, the Copyright Act 1957, anti-camcording rules, piracy's history.

☐ **MOV-17.5 Film policy and support**: NFDC, film city projects, state subsidies, co-production treaties, the National Film Heritage Mission (2016), France's CNC model, Korea's KOFIC.

☐ **MOV-17.6 Film preservation and archives**: nitrate film fires, the loss of silent films, NFAI (Pune, 1964), Film Heritage Foundation (Shivendra Singh Dungarpur, 2014), the Library of Congress, BFI National Archive, Cinémathèque française (Henri Langlois, 1936), FIAF (1938), restoration (e.g. *Kalpana*, 1948, restored by The Film Foundation).

☐ **MOV-17.7 Film education**: FTII (Pune, 1960), SRFTI (Kolkata, 1995), Whistling Woods (Mumbai, 2006), state film institutes; abroad: VGIK (Moscow, 1919, the oldest film school), Łódź, FAMU, NFTS, USC, NYU, La Fémis.

☐ **MOV-17.8 Careers in film**: every crew role as a career, unions and associations, how to start.

PART 8 — IDEAS: THEORY, PHILOSOPHY, PSYCHOLOGY AND SOCIETY

MOV-18 Film theory and criticism (the big ideas)

Before you start — MOV-18. Theory asks what cinema is and how it works on us. Each idea gets one line and its thinker.
See also: BOK literary theory, MOV-19.

- ☐ **MOV-18.1 Rasa and Indian aesthetics**: emotion as a "taste" for the audience (Natyashastra; Abhinavagupta); navarasa in Indian popular film.
- ☐ **MOV-18.2 Montage theory**: meaning from the collision of shots (Eisenstein, Kuleshov, Pudovkin).
- ☐ **MOV-18.3 Realism**: cinema as a window on reality, deep focus and the long take (André Bazin, Siegfried Kracauer).
- ☐ **MOV-18.4 Formalism**: cinema as art through its differences from reality (Rudolf Arnheim).
- ☐ **MOV-18.5 Auteur theory**: the director as author (Truffaut's "politique des auteurs", 1954; Andrew Sarris in the USA).
- ☐ **MOV-18.6 Genre theory**: how genres form, repeat and change (Rick Altman, Thomas Schatz).
- ☐ **MOV-18.7 Semiotics and structuralism**: film as a language of signs (Christian Metz).
- ☐ **MOV-18.8 Psychoanalytic film theory**: the spectator, desire and identification (Laura Mulvey's "male gaze", 1975; Christian Metz; Slavoj Žižek).
- ☐ **MOV-18.9 Feminist film theory**: women in front of and behind the camera; the Bechdel test (1985).
- ☐ **MOV-18.10 Postcolonial and Third Cinema theory**: cinema of the global South (Solanas and Getino; Ashish Rajadhyaksha on Indian cinema).
- ☐ **MOV-18.11 Cognitive film theory**: how perception and the mind process film (David Bordwell, Noël Carroll).
- ☐ **MOV-18.12 Star studies and audience studies**: what stars mean (Richard Dyer); how fans watch (fan clubs of Tamil and Telugu stars).
- ☐ **MOV-18.13 Deleuze's movement-image and time-image** and **Walter Benjamin's "aura" in the age of mechanical reproduction** (1935).

MOV-19 Cinema, mind and society

- ☐ **MOV-19.1 The psychology of watching**: attention, empathy, suspense (Hitchcock's bomb), immersion, the "willing suspension of disbelief" (Coleridge, 1817).
- ☐ **MOV-19.2 Emotion and the body**: why we cry, jump and laugh together; contagion of laughter in halls.
- ☐ **MOV-19.3 Fandom and celebrity worship**: Indian star temples and fan clubs; parasocial relationships.
- ☐ **MOV-19.4 Cinema and identity**: nation, language, caste, religion, gender, class on screen.
- ☐ **MOV-19.5 Representation**: who is seen, who is missing; stereotypes and their change.
- ☐ **MOV-19.6 Cinema and politics**: propaganda (*Triumph of the Will*), cinema as protest, film stars in politics (India's South).
- ☐ **MOV-19.7 Cinema and religion**: the devotional film, the theatre as temple (*Jai Santoshi Maa* audiences removing shoes).
- ☐ **MOV-19.8 Cinema and children**: media effects research, age ratings, learning from films.
- ☐ **MOV-19.9 Cinema and the economy**: jobs, tourism (film tourism to Switzerland and New Zealand), soft power (Raj Kapoor in the USSR, Korean wave).
- ☐ **MOV-19.10 Philosophy through film**: films as thought experiments on free will (*The Matrix*), memory (*Memento*), truth (*Rashomon*), death (*The Seventh Seal*), goodness (*Ikiru*).

PART 9 — REVIEWS AND VOICES

About this Part. Three kinds of pages. (1) **Critics' Corner**: the great critics, their style and lasting ideas. (2) **The critics said, I say**: for each film I review, what several respected critics said, summarised in my own words and linked to their full reviews, followed by my view. (3) **My Review Desk**: my personal reviews of films I have watched. I never copy a critic's review; I quote a few words at most, with credit, and link to the original.

MOV-20 Critics' Corner: the great film critics

☐ MOV-20.1 Critics of the world

- ☐ **André Bazin** (France, 1918–1958): co-founded *Cahiers du cinéma* (1951); champion of realism and the long take; "father" of the New Wave.
- ☐ **François Truffaut** (France): critic before director; his 1954 essay attacked "the tradition of quality" and launched auteurism.
- ☐ **James Agee** (USA): poetic reviews in *Time* and *The Nation* in the 1940s.
- ☐ **Pauline Kael** (USA, *The New Yorker* 1968–1991): passionate, personal, against snobbery; championed *Bonnie and Clyde*.
- ☐ **Andrew Sarris** (USA, *The Village Voice*): brought auteur theory to America (*The American Cinema*, 1968).
- ☐ **Roger Ebert** (USA, *Chicago Sun-Times*, 1967–2013): the first film critic to win a Pulitzer Prize (1975); "thumbs up" TV show with Gene Siskel; his "Great Movies" essays; he wrote that movies are "a machine that generates empathy".
- ☐ **Jonathan Rosenbaum**, **J. Hoberman**, **Manohla Dargis**, **A. O. Scott**, **Richard Brody**, **Kenneth Turan** (USA).
- ☐ **Mark Kermode** and **Peter Bradshaw** (UK); *Sight and Sound* magazine (BFI, 1932).
- ☐ **Tadao Sato** (Japan) and **Donald Richie** (Japan's American interpreter).
- ☐ **Serge Daney** (France), **Jean-Michel Frodon**, **Michel Ciment** (*Positif*).

☐ MOV-20.2 Critics and film writers of India

- ☐ **Chidananda Dasgupta**: co-founded the Calcutta Film Society with Satyajit Ray (1947); thoughtful critic and filmmaker.
- ☐ **Satyajit Ray** as a writer: *Our Films, Their Films* (1976).
- ☐ **Iqbal Masud**, **Amita Malik**, **Bikram Singh**, **Khalid Mohamed** (*Times of India*), **Bhawana Somaaya**, **Maithili Rao**.
- ☐ **Contemporary**: Anupama Chopra (Film Companion), Rajeev Masand, Baradwaj Rangan (Tamil and pan-Indian), Shubhra Gupta (*Indian Express*), Saibal Chatterjee, Raja Sen, Sudhir Srinivasan, Namrata Joshi, Mayank Shekhar, Sukanya Verma.
- ☐ **Historians and scholars**: Erik Barnouw and S. Krishnaswamy (*Indian Film*), Ashish Rajadhyaksha and Paul Willemen (*Encyclopaedia of Indian Cinema*), Firoze Rangoonwalla, Madhava Prasad, Ravi Vasudevan, S. Theodore Baskaran (Tamil cinema), P. K. Nair (archivist).

☐ MOV-20.3 Review aggregators and audience ratings

Rotten Tomatoes (1998; "Tomatometer" percentage of positive reviews), Metacritic (weighted average score), IMDb (1990; user ratings), Letterboxd (2011; social diary), BookMyShow ratings (India). One line on what each number really measures, and why a percentage is not a quality score.

MOV-21 The critics said, I say (page template)

Each page follows the same order:

1. **The film in two lines**: year, director, cast, what it is about (no spoilers).
2. **What the critics said**: 3 to 5 named critics, each summarised in one or two lines of my own words, with a link to the original review and its date.
3. **Where they agree and disagree**: one paragraph.
4. **What I say**: my view and why, in my own voice (link to MOV-22).
5. **If you liked this, watch next**: three linked films (tags).

MOV-22 My Review Desk (Kritikesh's review template)

☐ **Header**: title, year, language, director, cast, runtime, where to watch (dated), certificate.

☐ **My one-line verdict** (the answer first).

☐ **What it is about** (no spoilers).

☐ **What worked for me**: story, performances, direction, music, visuals.

☐ **What did not**.

☐ **Rasa meter**: which emotions it served (navarasa: love, laughter, compassion, anger, courage, fear, disgust, wonder, peace).

☐ **Who should watch it**: mood, age, patience level.

☐ **My rating** on a clear five-point scale, with what each point means.

☐ **Spoiler zone** (folded): discussion of the ending.

☐ **Tags and watch-next links**.

PART 10 — WATCHING, LEARNING AND COMMUNITY

MOV-23 The movie lover's practical guide

☐ **MOV-23.1 How to watch a film closely**: five questions to ask after any film (what did it want me to feel, how did it do it, what was left out, who made it and when, what stays with me).

☐ **MOV-23.2 Starter watch-lists**: 25 films to begin world cinema; 25 Indian films across languages; 10 films for children; 10 silent films; 10 documentaries (each list links to the registers).

☐ **MOV-23.3 Where to watch legally**: cinemas, film societies, public broadcasters, streaming platforms, free archives (NFDC's Cinemas of India, Internet Archive public-domain films, YouTube channels of archives); always dated.

☐ **MOV-23.4 Film societies and clubs**: the film society movement in India (Bombay Film Society 1942, Calcutta Film Society 1947, Federation of Film Societies of India 1959); college film clubs; online communities.

☐ **MOV-23.5 Festival calendar**: month by month (Sundance and Rotterdam in January, Berlin in February, Cannes in May, Venice in late August, TIFF in September, Busan in October, IFFI in November, IFFK in December, MAMI in October–November; check dates every year).

☐ **MOV-23.6 Museums of cinema**: National Museum of Indian Cinema (Mumbai, 2019), Academy Museum (Los Angeles, 2021), Museum of the Moving Image (New York), Cinémathèque française, Museo Nazionale del Cinema (Turin).

☐ **MOV-23.7 Learning filmmaking**: free courses, film schools, how to make a first short film with a phone, festivals that accept student films.

☐ **MOV-23.8 Watching well**: eye comfort, ratings for children, avoiding piracy (and why it hurts workers), respecting cinema-hall etiquette.

PART 11 — NAVIGATION: TAGS, LINKS AND THE SITE MAP

MOV-24 Tag dictionary

Every page carries tags from these controlled lists, so a reader can jump sideways.

- ☐ **Country and region**: #india #usa #uk #france #italy #germany #japan #china #hongkong #taiwan #southkorea #iran #turkey #egypt #nigeria #mexico #brazil #argentina #pakistan #bangladesh #nepal #srilanka #australia #newzealand and so on (ISO country names).
- ☐ **Indian language**: #hindi #tamil #telugu #malayalam #kannada #bengali #marathi #bhojpuri #odia #assamese #gujarati #punjabi #rajasthani #manipuri #konkani #tulu and others.
- ☐ **Decade**: #1890s to #2020s.
- ☐ **Genre and form**: every genre and sub-genre in MOV-06 and MOV-07.
- ☐ **Movement**: every movement in MOV-08.
- ☐ **Award**: #oscars #cannes #venice #berlin #bafta #nationalfilmaward #filmfare and others.
- ☐ **Person**: one tag per profiled person.
- ☐ **Mood and rasa**: #feelgood #tearjerker #mindbending #edgeofseat #comfortwatch #shringara #hasya #karuna #raudra #veera #bhayanaka #bibhatsa #adbhuta #shanta.
- ☐ **Reader level**: #beginner #fan #nerd.

MOV-25 Cross-links and the website site map

- ☐ **MOV-25.1 Cross-topic links**: Books (adaptations: BOK), Music (film songs and scores: MUS), Instruments (INS), Technology (camera, sound, VFX: TEC), Sports films (SPT), Cooking films (COK), Curriculum Index links (History, Art and Culture, Technology).
- ☐ **MOV-25.2 Suggested web addresses**: /movies/ (home, Gateway), /movies/why-we-love-movies/<leaf>/ (intro twig), /movies/industries/<country>/<industry>/ , /movies/industries/<industry>/films/<decade>/ , /movies/genres/<genre>/ , /movies/movements/<movement>/ , /movies/history/<era>/ , /movies/awards/<award>/ , /movies/festivals/<festival>/ , /movies/people/<name>/ , /movies/craft/<topic>/ , /movies/ideas/<topic>/ , /movies/reviews/critics/ , /movies/reviews/<film>/ , /movies/guide/<topic>/ .
- ☐ **MOV-25.3 Search phrases to own**: "what is Tollywood", "difference between Bollywood and Tollywood", "first Indian film", "list of film industries in India", "film industries of the world", "types of film genres", "Filmfare best film winners list", "National Film Award best feature film list", "Palme d'Or winners", "highest grossing Indian films", "how movies are made", "rasa theory in cinema", with a Hindi line for Indian searchers ("bharat ki pehli film kaun si thi").

PART 12 — SOURCES, CREDITS AND EDITOR'S NOTES

MOV-S Sources and credits

Knowledge belongs to the people who made it. These are the sources this index stands on; every page on the website will cite its own.

☐ **Reference works**: Ashish Rajadhyaksha and Paul Willemen, *Encyclopaedia of Indian Cinema* (BFI/Oxford, revised 1999); Erik Barnouw and S. Krishnaswamy, *Indian Film* (2nd ed., 1980); David Bordwell and Kristin Thompson, *Film History: An Introduction* and *Film Art*; Geoffrey Nowell-Smith (ed.), *The Oxford History of World Cinema* (1996); Encyclopaedia Britannica (cinema, film history and biography entries); Tom Gunning, "The Cinema of Attractions" (1986).

☐ **Official award and festival sources**: Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences (oscars.org; Official Academy Awards Database); BAFTA (bafta.org); Festival de Cannes (festival-cannes.com); La Biennale di Venezia (labiennale.org, "Official awards of the 83rd Venice International Film Festival", September 2026); Berlinale (berlinale.de); Press Information Bureau and NFDC (National Film Awards, Dadasaheb Phalke Award); Filmfare (filmfare.com); FIAPF (fiapf.org) for accredited festivals.

☐ **Data and statistics**: Central Board of Film Certification annual reports; UNESCO Institute for Statistics (feature film production); Box Office Mojo and The Numbers; Euronews, "Avengers: Endgame dethrones Avatar once more" (5 October 2026); Ormax Media and FICCI-EY media reports (Indian box office); Guinness World Records.

☐ **Archives**: National Film Archive of India (NFDC-NFAI, Pune); Library of Congress (National Film Registry; 2013 report on the survival of American silent features); BFI National Archive; Film Heritage Foundation.

☐ **News reports used to check 2025–2026 winners**: Khaleej Times (98th Oscars winners), Outlook India (Cannes 2026 winners; Filmfare 2025 winners), Deccan Herald and IANS (71st National Film Awards), The Statesman and Euronews (BAFTA 2026), Arab News and Inter Film (Berlinale 2026), Euronews (Venice 2026).

☐ **Criticism**: Roger Ebert's reviews (rogerebert.com); *Sight and Sound* greatest films polls (BFI, 2012 and 2022); Pauline Kael, *For Keeps*; André Bazin, *What Is Cinema?*; Satyajit Ray, *Our Films, Their Films*.

MOV-E Editor's notes (corrections and decisions on the brief)

1. **"Tollywood" for all South Indian films** was corrected: Tollywood means Telugu (and also Kolkata's Bengali) cinema; the South has four major industries plus Tulu and others, each with its own section.
2. **"List every film ever made"**: more than a million feature films exist, so the booklet gives a sourced landmark register for each industry plus a clear plan ("How the registers grow", MOV-05.6) to fill the full year-wise lists on the website from official databases.
3. **Box-office figures** are given only where well documented, with the type (worldwide gross, etc.) and date; Indian "net" and "gross" are explained.
4. **Latest winners** were checked on the web on 3 November 2026; where a fact could not be verified (for example the latest Golden Globes), the entry says so instead of guessing.
5. **Reviews**: critic reviews will be summarised in my own words with links; never copied.
6. **Numbering**: the ID system (MOV-01 to MOV-25) matches the Curriculum Index style, so the same IDs can be used in a future Movies sheet and on the website.
7. **Added beyond the brief**: film movements (Part 3), the full timeline (Part 4), festivals and records, the crew and technology Part, film theory and psychology, film preservation, the film-society movement, tag dictionary and a site map with search phrases.

MOV-T My Movie Tracker

Use the ☐ boxes across the booklet to tick what you have watched or explored. A simple tracker for each Part: Part · Sections · Explored · Date started · Date finished.

Progress tracker

Part	Sections	Explored ☐	Started	Finished
PART 0 — THE INTRODUCTION TWIG: WHY DO WE LOVE THE MOVIES?	14			
PART 1 — FILM INDUSTRIES OF THE WORLD	5			
PART 2 — GENRES, FORMS AND FORMATS	2			
PART 3 — MOVEMENTS, SCHOOLS AND STYLES	1			
PART 4 — THE HISTORY OF CINEMA: A TIMELINE	1			
PART 5 — AWARDS, FESTIVALS AND RECORDS	4			
PART 6 — THE PEOPLE OF CINEMA	1			
PART 7 — THE CRAFT, TECHNOLOGY AND BUSINESS OF FILM	3			
PART 8 — IDEAS: THEORY, PHILOSOPHY, PSYCHOLOGY AND SOCIETY	2			
PART 9 — REVIEWS AND VOICES	3			
PART 10 — WATCHING, LEARNING AND COMMUNITY	1			
PART 11 — NAVIGATION: TAGS, LINKS AND THE SITE MAP	2			
PART 12 — SOURCES, CREDITS AND EDITOR'S NOTES	3			